MIL-STD-810 (USAF)
14 JUNE 1962

MILITARY STANDARD

ENVIRONMENTAL TEST METHODS

FOR AEROSPACE

AND

GROUND EQUIPMENT

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DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE

1. This standard has been approved by the Air Force and is published to establish environmental test methods for aerospace and ground equipment.

2. Use of this standard by activities under cognizance of the Air Force shall be mandatory effective on date of issue.

3. Recommended corrections, additions, or deletions should be addressed to: Commander, Aeronautical Systems Division, Attn: ASTEVC.

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SECTION 1

SCOPE

1.1 **PURPOSE.** This standard establishes uniform methods for environmental tests for determining the resistance of aerospace and ground equipment to the deleterious effects of natural and induced environments peculiar to military operations. The test methods contained herein are intended to specify suitable conditions obtainable in the laboratory which give test results similar to actual service conditions, to obtain reproducibility of the results of tests, and to serve as a guide for those engaged in preparing the environmental test portions of detail specifications. **THIS STANDARD IS INTENDED FOR NEW ENGINEERING AND DESIGN. IT SHOULD NOT BE APPLIED IN RETROSPECT.**

1.2 **APPLICATION OF TEST METHODS.** The test methods contained in this standard apply broadly to all items of aerospace and ground equipment, except air frames and primary power plants, and generally represent the extreme conditions which usually constitute the minimum acceptable conditions. **WHEN IT IS KNOWN THAT THE EQUIPMENT WILL ENCOUNTER CONDITIONS MORE SEVERE OR LESS SEVERE THAN THE ENVIRONMENTAL LEVELS STATED HEREIN, THE TEST MAY BE MODIFIED BY THE DETAIL SPECIFICATION.**

1.3 **NUMBERING SYSTEM.** The test methods are designated by the numbers 500 through 599 inclusive. The test methods are serially numbered in the order in which they are introduced into this standard.

1.3.1 **Revision of Test Methods.** Any revision of test methods is indicated by a letter following the method number. For example, the original number assigned to the first test method is 500; the first revision of that method is 500 A, the second revision 500 B, etc. Any such revisions are contained in the last page of this standard. It is intended that each test method be independently revised, either totally or in part, when the need arises.

1.4 **IDENTIFICATION OF TEST METHODS.** The test methods contained in this standard are identified as follows:

Test Method No.	Method Title
500	Low Pressure
501	High Temperature
502	Low Temperature
503	Temperature Shock
504	Temperature-Altitude (Cycling)
505	Sunshine
506	Rain
507	Humidity
508	Fungus
509	Salt Fog
510	Sand and Dust
511	Explosion
512	Immersion (Leakage)
513	Acceleration
514	Vibration
515	Acoustical Noise
516	Shock
517	Low Pressure-Solar Energy

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SECTION 2

APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

The issues of the following documents in effect on the date of invitation for bids, form a part of this standard to the extent specified herein.

Specifications
Military

MIL-G-5572	Gasoline, Aviation: Grades 80/87, 91/96, 100/130, 115/145
MIL-J-5624	Jet Fuel, Grades JP-3, JP-4, and JP-5
MIL-M-8090	Mobility Requirements, Ground Support Equipment, General Specifications for
MIL-F-8261	Fungus Resistance Tests, Aeronautical and Associated Materials, General Specification for
MIL-C-8811	Chamber, Rain Testing
MIL-C-9435	Chamber, Explosion-Proof Testing
MIL-C-9436	Chamber, Sand and Dust Testing
MIL-C-9452	Chamber, Fungus Resistance Testing

OTHER PUBLICATIONS. The following documents form a part of this standard to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids shall apply.

AD 229482

AFCRC Technical Report 59-267—ARDC Model Atmosphere, 1959
(Armed Services Technical Information Agency, Arlington Hall Station, Arlington 12, Virginia)

S 1. 1-1960

American Standard Acoustical Terminology (Including Mechanical Shock and Vibration)
(American Standards Association Inc., 10 East 40th Street, New York 16, New York)

Method D880

The Incline Impact Test for Shipping Containers
(American Society for Testing Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia 3, Pennsylvania)

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SECTION 3

GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

3.1 FORMULATION OF TEST. The test shall be performed in the manner and sequence or combination specified in the detail specification. When the test sequence is not specified it is SUGGESTED that the test sequence for the applicable equipment category and its intended use be selected from table I. When selecting tests the anticipated environmental conditions should be carefully considered. Only those conditions that reflect actual service usage, including shipping and ground handling, should be taken into account. Those conditions which would adversely affect or most probably induce a malfunction of the test item should be given emphasis.

3.2 PERFORMANCE OF TEST.

3.2.1 Pretest Performance Record. Prior to conducting any of the tests the test item shall be operated under standard ambient conditions and a record made of all data necessary to determine compliance with required performance. These data shall provide the criteria for checking satisfactory performance of the test item during or at the conclusion of the test.

3.2.2 Installation Of Test Item In Test Facility. The test item shall be installed in the test facility at room temperature in a manner that will simulate service usage. Plugs, covers, and inspection plates used in service shall remain in place. When mechanical or electrical connections are not used the connections normally protected in service shall be adequately covered. The test item shall then be operated to determine that no malfunction or damage was caused due to faulty installation or handling. The requirement for operation following installation of the test item in the test facility is applicable only when operation is required during exposure to the specified test.

3.2.3 Performance Check During Test. When operation of the test item is required during the test exposure, the operation and performance checks shall be of sufficient duration or shall be repeated at appropriate times and intervals to insure a record of comprehensive comparative data for comparison with data recorded under standard conditions as specified in 3.2.1.

3.2.4 Inspection and Failure Criteria. When specified herein the test item shall be visually inspected and a record made of any damage resulting from the test. Deterioration, corrosion, or change in performance tolerance limits of any internal or external components which could in any manner prevent the test item from meeting operational requirements shall provide reason to consider the test item as having failed to withstand the conditions of the test.

3.3 TEST CONDITIONS. Unless otherwise specified herein, or in the detail specification, all measurements and tests shall be made at room ambient temperature, atmospheric pressure, and relative humidity. Whenever these conditions must be closely controlled in order to obtain reproducible results a reference temperature of 23°C (73°F), a relative humidity of 50 percent, and an atmospheric pressure of 30 inches of mercury respectively shall be used together with whatever tolerances are required to obtain the desired precision of measurement. Actual ambient test conditions should be recorded periodically during the test period.

3.3.1 Measurements of Test Conditions. All measurements of test conditions shall be made with instruments of the accuracy specified in 3.3.3.

3.3.2 Tolerance of Test Conditions. The maximum allowable tolerances of test conditions (exclusive of accuracy of instruments) except as stated in the test method or in the detail specification, shall be as follows:

a. Temperature: plus or minus 2°C (3.6°F)

b. Pressure: When measured by manometers, plus or minus 5 percent
When measured by vacuum ion gauges, plus or minus 10 percent.

c. Relative Humidity: plus 5 percent R. H., minus 0 percent

d. Vibration Amplitude: Sinusoidal plus or minus 10 percent
Random plus or minus 30 percent

e. Acceleration: plus or minus 10 percent

3.3.3 Accuracy of Test Apparatus. The accuracy of instruments and test equipment used to control or monitor the test parameters,

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TABLE I

Suggested Test Sequence for Aerospace and Ground Equipment

	GROUND					AEROSPACE (Note 1)									
	Equipment Category					Equipment Category									
Test	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
Temperature and Pressure															
Low Pressure	1	1	1	3	3	4	2	2	2	2	3	4	3	2	3
High Temperature	2	2	2	2	2	1	1	1	3	1	1	1	1	1	2
Low Temperature	4	4	3	1	1	2	3	3	1	4	2	3	2	3	1
Temperature Shock	—	—	—	—	—	2[3,1]	2[5,1]	2[5,1]	2[5,1]	2[3,1]	2[5,1]	2	4	3[5,1]	2[5,1]
Temperature Altitude (Cycling)	—	—	—	—	—	5[5]	5[4]	5[4]	5[4]	3[5,5,1]	5[4]	5[5]	5[5]	5[4]	5[4]
Sunshine	3[1]	3[1]	—	4[1]	4[1]	—	—	—	—	—	—	3[6]	—	—	—
Corrosion and Erosion															
Rain	6[1]	6	4	9[1]	9	—	6[1]	7[1]	7[1]	3[6,1]	—	—	3[6,1]	—	—
Humidity	7	7	5	10	10	7	7	8	8	7	6	9	7	6[1]	11
Fungus	8	8	6	11	11	8	8	9	9	3[8,1]	7	10	8	3[7,1]	12
Salt Fog	9[1]	9	7	12[1]	12	9[1]	9[1]	10[1]	10[1]	3[9,1]	8[1]	3[11,1]	3[9]	3[8,1]	3[13,1]
Sand and Dust	5[1]	5	8	5[1]	5	6	10[3]	11[3]	6	10	9	7	10	3[9]	6
Immersion (Leakage)	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	6[1]	—	—	—	8	—	—	—
Mechanical															
Acceleration	—	—	—	—	—	10	11	12	11	11	10	12	11	10	7
Explosion	—	—	9	6[1]	6[1]	3[11]	—	—	12[3]	—	11[3]	3[13,1]	12	2[11,1]	2[8,1]
Shock	10	10	10	7	7	12	12	13	13	12	12	15	13	12	9
Vibration	11	11	11	8	8	13	13	14	14	13	13	14	14	13	10
Acoustical Noise	—	—	—	—	—	4[14,1]	4[14,1]	4[15,1]	15	14	14	16[1]	15	14	14

Note 1. Aerospace includes equipment installed in airplanes, helicopters, air launched and ground launched missiles.

[1] Test with limited application.
[2] Test recommended for missiles in addition to those tests not marked.
[3] Test not generally applicable to airborne or ground launched missiles.
[4] Test not generally applicable to aircraft and helicopters.
[5] Test not generally applicable to ground launched missiles.

Equipment Category

Ground

1. General Base (sheltered) and 2. General Base (unsheltered) } All ground equipment not included in electronics and communications or aircraft and missile support classes.
3. Aircraft and Missile Support. Equipment used outdoors on airfields and missile launching pads for servicing, maintenance, checkout, support, etc. Electronic equipment not included.
4. Communications and Electronics (sheltered) 5. Communications and Electronics (unsheltered) } Communication and electronic equipment of all types and equipment with electric circuits.

Aerospace

6. Auxiliary Power Plants and Power Plant Accessories. All such equipment for aircraft, helicopters and missiles. Primary power plants excluded.
7. Liquid Systems. Liquid carrying or hydraulic actuated equipment.
8. Gas Systems. Gas carrying or gas actuated equipment.
9. Electrical Equipment. All electrical equipment but not electronic.
10. Mechanical Equipment. Equipment having only mechanical operating parts.
11. Autopilots, Gyros, and Guidance Equipment. All such equipment and accessories but not electronic.
12. Instruments. Includes indicators, electric meters, signal devices etc., but not electronic equipment.
13. Armament. Guns, bombing and rocket equipment and accessories but not electronic equipment.
14. Photographic Equipment. All aerospace still and motion picture cameras and optical devices.
15. Electronic and Communications Equipment. All such equipments.

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whether located at a Government testing laboratory or at the contractor's plant shall be verified periodically (at least once every 12 months, preferably once every 6 months) to the satisfaction of the procuring activity. All instruments and test equipment used in conducting the tests specified herein shall:

a. Conform to laboratory standards whose calibration is traceable to the prime standards at the U. S. Bureau of Standards.

b. Have an accuracy of at least one-fifth the tolerance for the variable to be measured.

c. Be appropriate for measuring the environmental conditions concerned.

3.3.4 **Stabilization of Test Temperature.** Unless otherwise specified, temperature stabilization will have been attained when the temperature of a centrally located component or part of the test item having the largest mass does not change more than 2°C per hour.

3.4 **TEST FACILITIES AND APPARATUS.** Test facilities, chambers and apparatus used in conducting the tests contained in this standard shall be capable of meeting the conditions required.

3.4.1 **Test Chamber.**

3.4.1.1 **Volume of Test Chamber.** The volume of the test chamber shall be such that the bulk of the item under test will not interfere with the generation and maintenance of test conditions.

3.4.1.2 **Heat Source.** The heat source of the test facility shall be so located that radiant heat will not fall directly on the test item, except where application of radiant heat is one of the test conditions.

3.4.1.3 **Location of Temperature Sensors.** Unless otherwise specified, thermocouples or equivalent temperature sensors utilized to determine the specified ambient chamber temperature shall be centrally located within the test chamber where possible and baffled or otherwise protected so as to prevent the direct impingement of conditioned air.

3.4.2 **Vibration and Shock Test Apparatus.**

3.4.2.1 **Instrumentation.** Suitable vibration or shock measuring instrumentation shall be utilized to determine that the correct input is applied to the test item. Generally the vibration or shock input should be monitored at the beginning of the test and whenever there is a change in the test setup, type of input, or method of conducting the test. It is not mandatory that each individual input be monitored, but it is intended that measuring instrumentation be utilized to the extent necessary to insure that the specified input is attained.

3.4.2.2 **Transducer Mounting.** The monitoring transducer shall be rigidly attached to and located on or near the attachment point or points of the test item.

Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.

Copies of this standard for military use may be obtained as indicated in the foreword to, or the general provisions of, the Index of Military Specifications and Standards.

The title and identifying symbol should be stipulated when requesting copies of military standards.

NOTICE: When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specification, or other data is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

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METHOD 500
LOW PRESSURE

1. **PURPOSE.** The low pressure test is conducted to determine the deleterious effects of reduced pressure on aerospace and ground equipment. Damaging effects of low pressure include leakage of gases or fluids from gasket sealed enclosures and rupture of pressurized containers. Under low pressure conditions low density materials tend to sublime and many materials change their physical and chemical properties. Damage due to low pressure may be augmented or accelerated by the contraction, embrittlement, and fluid congealing induced by low temperature. Erratic operation or malfunction of equipment may result from arcing or corona. Greatly decreased efficiency of convection and conduction as heat transfer mechanisms under low pressure conditions is encountered. The test procedures described are intended to serve several purposes. Procedure I is applicable to ground equipment. The test is conducted to determine the ability of ground equipment to withstand the reduced pressure encountered during shipment by air and for satisfactory operation under those pressure conditions found at high ground elevations. Procedure II is applicable to installed aerospace equipment. This test is performed to determine the ability of equipment to operate satisfactorily following exposure to both reduced pressure and temperature conditions encountered during flight.

2. **PROCEDURE.**

Procedure I. Ground Equipment. The test item shall be placed in the test chamber in accordance with section 3.2.2. The internal chamber temperature shall be uncontrolled during the test. The chamber internal pressure shall be reduced to 3.44 inches of mercury (50,000 feet above sea level) and maintained for a period of not less than 1 hour. The chamber pressure shall then be increased to 20.58 inches of mercury (10,000 feet above sea level) and the test item operated. The results shall be compared with the data obtained in section 3.2.1. The chamber shall then be returned to room pressure and the test item inspected in accordance with section 3.2.4.

Procedure II. Aerospace Equipment. The test item shall be placed in the test chamber in accordance with section 3.2.2. The test chamber internal temperature shall be reduced to —54°C (—65°F). The test chamber internal pressure shall then be reduced to the lowest pressure condition for which the test item is designed to operate while maintaining the specified temperature. (When performance requirements are specified in altitude in feet the equivalent pressure can be obtained from the ARDC Model Atmosphere, 1959). The conditions of pressure and temperature shall be maintained for a period of not less than 1 hour. At the conclusion of this time period and while at the specified pressure and temperature the test item shall be operated and the results compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1. With the test item still operating, the test chamber internal pressure shall be gradually increased to room pressure. The rate of pressure change shall be as specified in the detail specification. During this period special attention shall be given to electrical and electronic test items for erratic operation or malfunction resulting from arcing or corona. The test item shall then be removed from the test chamber and inspected as specified in section 3.2.4.

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METHOD 501

HIGH TEMPERATURE

1. **PURPOSE.** The high temperature test is conducted to determine the resistance of aerospace and ground equipment to elevated temperatures that may be encountered during service life either in storage without protective packaging or under service conditions. In equipment, high temperature conditions may cause the permanent set of packings and gaskets. Binding of parts may also result in items of complex construction due to differential expansion of dissimilar metals. Rubber, plastic, and plywood may tend to discolor, crack, bulge, check or craze. Closure and sealing strips may partially melt and adhere to contacting parts. The minimum temperature of 52°C (125°F) is established as representing the maximum temperature of the ambient air. The temperature of 71°C (160°F) results from the addition of 19.4°C or 35°F due to solar radiation and the higher temperatures are those resulting from the operation or confinement within cases or enclosures of equipment which generate heat as a by-product.

2. **PROCEDURE**

Procedure I. The test item shall be placed in the test chamber in accordance with section 3.2.2. The internal chamber temperature shall be raised to 71°C (160°F) and maintained for a period of not less than 48 hours. The internal chamber relative humidity shall not exceed 15 per cent. At the conclusion of the exposure period the internal chamber temperature shall then be adjusted to the highest operating temperature under which the test item is designed to operate and maintained until temperature stabilization of the test item is reached. The test item shall then be operated and the results compared with the data obtained in section 3.2.1. The test item shall then be removed from the test chamber, returned to room temperature and inspected as specified in section 3.2.4.

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METHOD 502

LOW TEMPERATURE

1. **PURPOSE.** The low temperature test is conducted to determine the effects of low temperature on aerospace and ground equipment during storage (without protective packaging) or service use. Differential contraction of metal parts, loss of resiliency of packings and gaskets, and congealing of lubricants are a few of the difficulties associated with low temperatures. The following conditions are established as standard: —62°C (—80°F) for transportation and storage, —54°C (—65°F) for world wide operation, —40°C (—40°F) for operation in Continental United States, and 2°C (35°F) for equipment operated in temperature controlled areas.

2. **PROCEDURE.**

Procedure I. The test item shall be placed in the test chamber in accordance with section 3.2.2. The internal chamber temperature shall be lowered to —62°C (—80°F) and maintained for a period of not less than 48 hours. At the conclusion of the exposure period the test item may be removed from the test chamber and inspected in accordance with section 3.2.4. The internal chamber temperature shall then be adjusted to the lowest temperature under which the test item is designed to operate and maintained until temperature stabilization of the test item is reached. The test item shall then be operated and the results compared with the data obtained in section 3.2.1. The test item shall be removed from the test chamber, returned to room temperature and inspected as specified in section 3.2.4.

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METHOD 503

TEMPERATURE SHOCK

1. **PURPOSE.** The temperature shock test is conducted to determine the effects on aerospace and ground equipment of sudden changes in temperature of the surrounding atmosphere. Cracking or rupture of materials due to sudden dimensional changes by expansion or contraction is the principal difficulty to be anticipated. This could occur in service to aerospace equipment during rapid altitude changes and to ground equipment being moved from heated storage buildings to low temperature outdoor areas, or vice versa.

2. **PROCEDURE.**

Procedure I. The test item shall be placed in the test chamber in accordance with section 3.2.2 and the internal chamber temperature raised to 85°C (185°F), or to the temperature specified in the detail specification, and maintained for a period of not less than 4 hours. At the conclusion of this time period the test item shall, within 5 minutes, be transferred to a cold chamber with an internal temperature of —40°C (—40°F). The equipment shall be exposed to this temperature for a period of not less than 4 hours. At the conclusion of this time period the test item shall, within 5 minutes, be returned to the high temperature chamber maintained at 85°C (185°F). This constitutes one cycle. The number of continuous cycles shall be three. The duration of exposure at each extreme temperature shall not be less than that specified and may be extended to overnight exposure to prevent interruption of the transfer sequence. At the conclusion of the low temperature portion of the third cycle, the test item shall be removed from the test chamber, returned to room temperature, and within a period of one hour operated and the results compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1. The test item shall then be inspected as specified in section 3.2.4.

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METHOD 504

TEMPERATURE-ALTITUDE (CYCLING)

1. PURPOSE. The temperature - altitude test is intended to apply to aerospace equipment and is conducted to determine the ability of equipment to operate satisfactorily under simultaneously applied varying conditions of low pressure, high and low temperature and high relative humidity. Deleterious effects to be anticipated include leakage of gases or fluids from sealed enclosures, rupture of pressurized containers, congealing of lubricants, cracking or rupture of materials due to contraction or expansion, short circuiting of electrical wiring and other damaging effects which might be expected from exposure to any of the above environments singly. In addition, equipment dependent on a convection type cooling system may be affected due to the reduction of efficiency of heat dissipation in less dense air.

2. ENVIRONMENTAL CONDITIONS. The test procedures specified herein are designed to determine that equipment will operate satisfactorily under the environmental conditions outlined in table 504–I.

TABLE 504–I

ENVIRONMENTAL CONDITIONS				
Equipment Class *	Equipment Mode		Temperature	Altitude
	Continuous	Non-operating		
1	x		—54 to 55°C	Sea level to 50,000 feet
		x	—62 to 85°C	
1A	x		—54 to 55°C	Sea level to 30,000 feet
		x	—62 to 85°C	
2	x		—54 to 71°C	Sea level to 70,000 feet
		x	—62 to 95°C	
3	x		—54 to 95°C	Sea level to 80,000 feet
		x	—62 to 150°C	
4	x		—54 to 125°C	
		x	—62 to 260°C	

* Equipment classes, as used in this test method, are established for illustrating the equipment operating mode-temperature altitude relationship and are not intended to be analogous to equipment categories used elsewhere within this standard.

3. PROCEDURE.

Procedure I. The test item shall be placed in the test chamber in accordance with section 3.2.2 making connections and attaching instrumentation as necessary. In general, the testing schedule outlined in table 504–II shall be followed. However, each step in table 504–II represents a condition which the test item may encounter in service, therefore, each step may be applied independently of the others. Alternate temperature-altitude conditions and test item operating modes are given in figures 504–1 through 504–4. When changing chamber conditions from those required for one step to those required for any other step, the sequence given in table 504–II or in any sequence, the rates of temperature and pressure changes shall be the maximum permitted by the chamber, but these rates shall not exceed 1°C (1.8°F) per second and 0.5 inch of mercury per second. Pressures for altitudes are contained in the ARDC Model Atmosphere, 1959.

Step 1—With the test item nonoperating, adjust the test chamber conditions to those specified for step 1 in table 504–II. The test item temperature shall be stabilized and maintained for at least 2 hours. Where it is possible without changing the temperature condition, a visual inspection of the test item shall be made to determine whether or not deterioration which would impair future operation has occurred.

Step 2—With the test item nonoperating, adjust the chamber conditions to those specified for step 2 in table 504–II. After the test item temperature has stabilized, the test item shall be turned on at the lowest specified input voltage. The test item shall operate satisfactorily within

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Table 504-II. Test chamber conditions for temperature-altitude tests.

Class	Step	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
1	Temp	-62°C	-54°C	-54°C	-10°C	85°C	55°C	71°C	omit	30°C	47°C	20°C	35°C	Omit	Room ambient
	Alt (in ft)	Atm	Atm	50,000	Atm	Atm	Atm	Atm		40,000	40,000	50,000	50,000		
	Time	2 hrs				16 hrs	4 hrs	30 min		4 hrs	30 min	4 hrs	30 min		
1A	Temp	-62°C	-54°C	-54°C	-10°C	85°C	55°C	71°C	omit	48°C	64°C	40°C	57°C	Omit	Room ambient
	Alt (in ft)	Atm	Atm	30,000	Atm	Atm	Atm	Atm		20,000	20,000	30,000	30,000		
	Time	2 hrs				16 hrs	4 hrs	30 min		4 hrs	30 min	4 hrs	30 min		
2	Temp	-62°C	-54°C	-54°C	-10°C	95°C	71°C	95°C	omit	36°C	60°C	10°C	35°C	Omit	Room ambient
	Alt (in ft)	Atm	Atm	70,000	Atm	Atm	Atm	Atm		50,000	50,000	70,000	70,000		
	Time	2 hrs				16 hrs	4 hrs	30 min		4 hrs	30 min	4 hrs	30 min		
3	Temp	-62°C	-54°C	-54°C	-10°C	150°C	95°C	125°C	150°C	60°C	90°C	20°C	50°C	75°C	Room ambient
	Alt (in ft)	Atm	Atm	80,000	Atm	Atm	Atm	Atm	Atm	50,000	50,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	
	Time	2 hrs				16 hrs	4 hrs	30 min	10 min	4 hrs	30 min	4 hrs	30 min	10 min	
4	Temp	-62°C	-54°C	-54°C	-10°C	260°C	125°C	150°C	260°C	90°C	115°C	50°C	75°C	185°C	Room ambient
	Alt (in ft)	Atm	Atm	80,000	Atm	Atm	Atm	Atm	Atm	50,000	50,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	
	Time	2 hrs				16 hrs	4 hrs	30 min	10 min	4 hrs	30 min	4 hrs	30 min	10 min	

* For class of equipment see figures 504-1 through 504-4 and table 504-I

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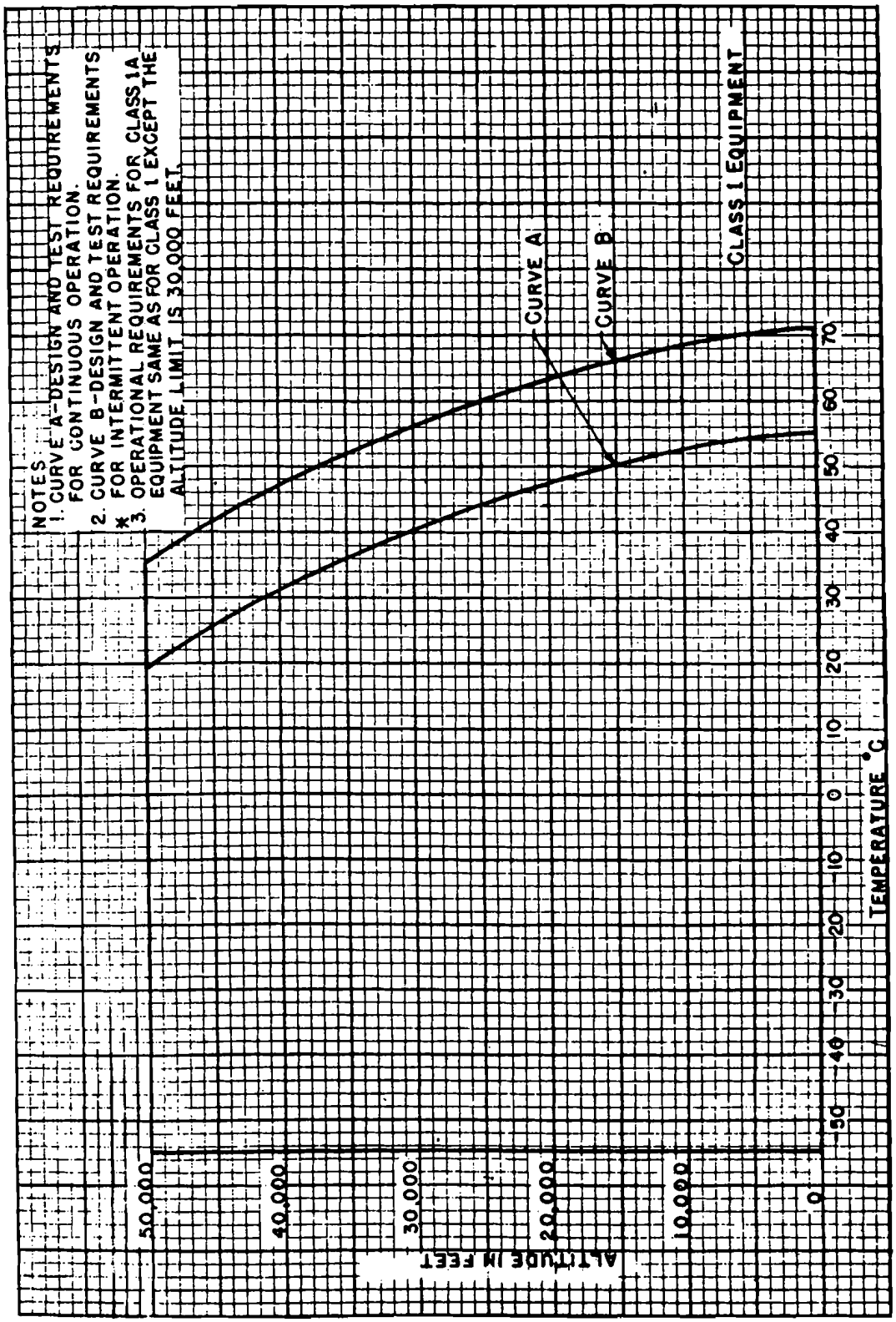


*Figure 504-1. Operational requirements for class 1 and 1A aerospace equipment. Temperature vs. altitude.**

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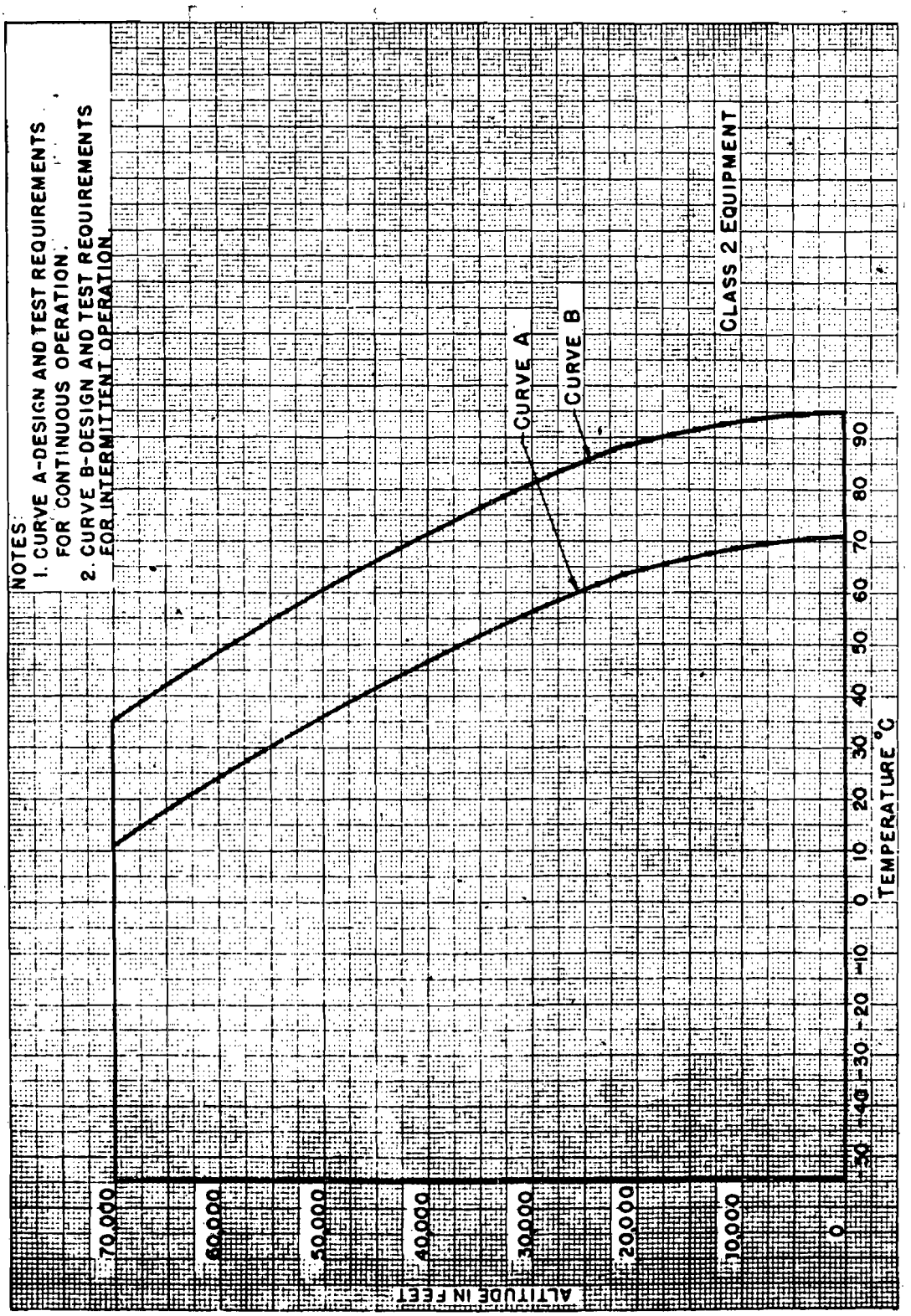


Figure 504–2. Operational requirements for class 2 aerospace equipment. Temperature vs. altitude.

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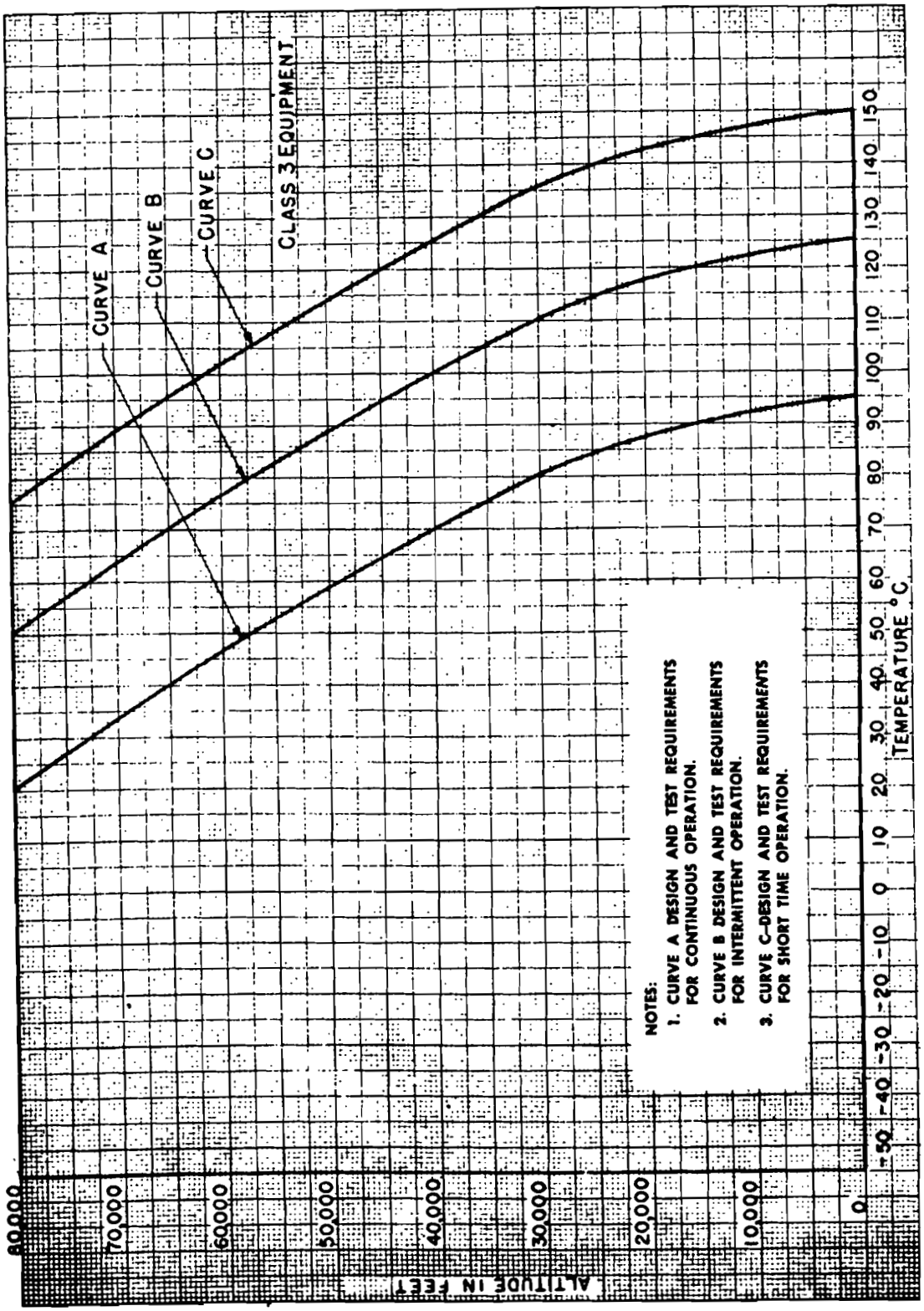


Figure 504-3. Operational requirements for class 3 aerospace equipment. Temperature vs. altitude.

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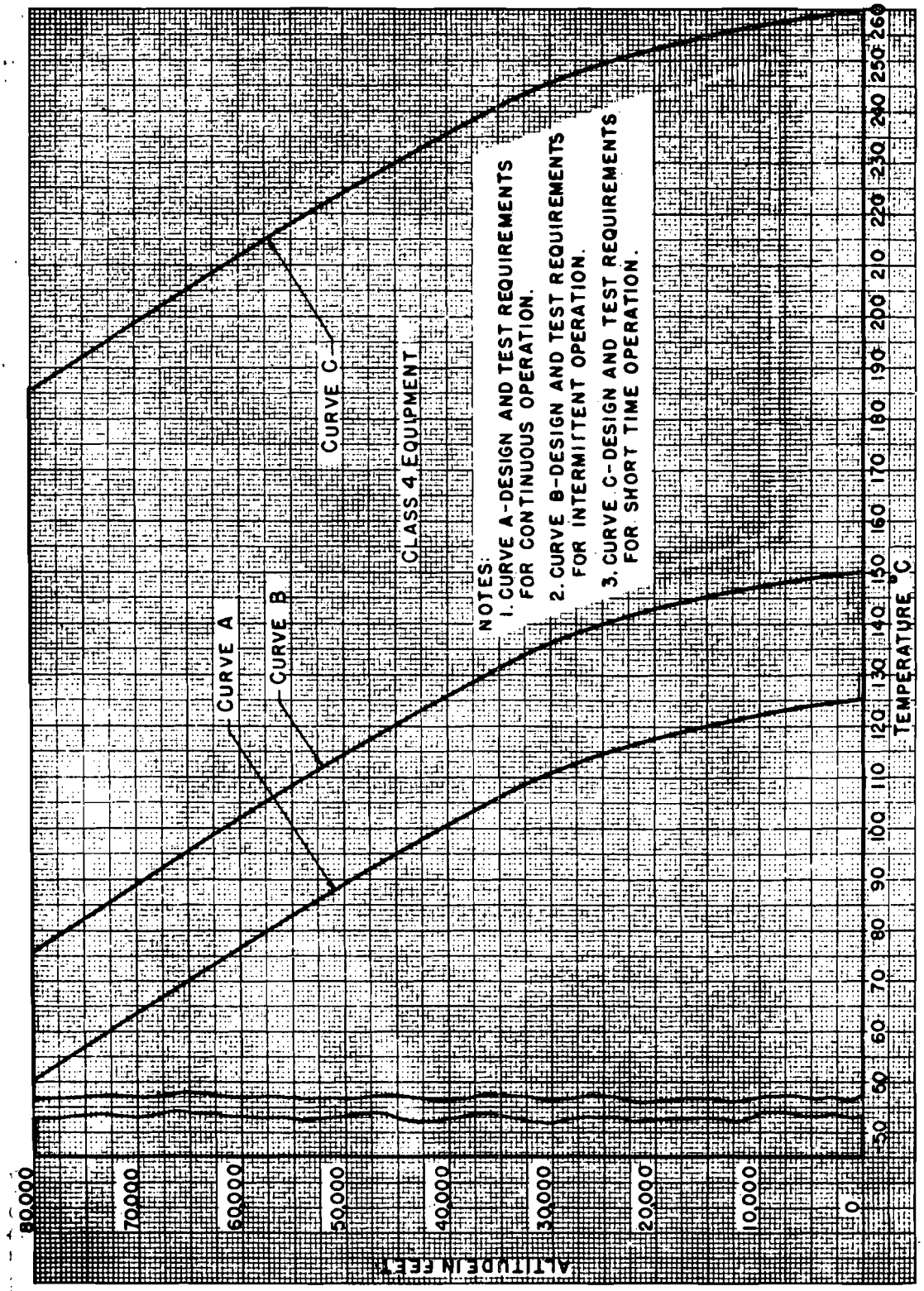


Figure 504–4. Operational requirements for class 4 aerospace equipment. Temperature vs. altitude.

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the specified warmup time. The test item shall then be turned off and restabilized at —54°C (—65°F). This constitutes 1 cycle. The operation cycle shall be repeated 2 more times (see notes (a) and (b)). The ambient temperature shall be maintained at —54°C (—65°F).

Note (a) Satisfactory operation within the specified warmup time shall be determined by checking to see if the visual or aural presentations or other performance characteristics appear normal.

Note (b) All characteristics which are likely to be affected by low temperatures shall be checked first. Should the time required to check the test item exceed 15 minutes beyond the warmup time, the test item shall again be stabilized at —54°C (—65°F) and the operational check continued.

Step 3—With the test item nonoperating, permit the test item to stabilize at the temperature specified in step 3 of table 504–II. The test item shall then be turned on and the altitude adjusted to that specified. Upon reaching the specified altitude, an operational and performance check shall be made at the highest specified input voltage and the result recorded.

Step 4—With the test item nonoperating, adjust the chamber conditions to those specified for step 4 in table 504–II. After test item temperature has stabilized, the test chamber door shall be opened and frost permitted to form on the test item. The door shall remain open long enough for the frost to melt but not long enough to allow the moisture to evaporate. (See note (c)). The chamber door shall be closed and the test item turned on at the highest specified input voltage to see if it operates satisfactorily within the specified warmup time. The test item shall be turned on and off at least three times. (See notes (a) and (d)).

Note (c) When the chamber door is opened it is intended that frost will form; however, should the relative humidity of the air be such that frost will not form, an artificial means shall be used to provide the relative humidity necessary to have frost form.

Note (d) After completion of the cold test (steps 1, 2, 3, and 4), and prior to starting the high temperature tests, a reference run shall be made in accordance with section 3.2.1. The reference run shall be made at the highest specified input voltages and data obtained compared with that of the reference run made prior to step 1.

Step 5—With the test item nonoperating, adjust the chamber conditions to those specified for step 5 in table 504–II. The chamber temperature shall be stabilized and maintained for at least 16 hours. At the conclusion of this period the test item shall, when practicable, be visually inspected to determine the extent of any deterioration.

Step 6—With the test item nonoperating, adjust the chamber conditions to those specified for step 6 in table 504–II. After the chamber conditions and the test item temperature have stabilized, turn the test item on at the highest specified input voltage and permit it to operate continuously for the period of time specified in table 504–II. Thermocouple readings shall be recorded every 30 minutes. At the end of the specified period of operation, and still at the specified chamber conditions, continue to operate the test item until is has been checked for satisfactory operation and results recorded.

Step 7—With the test item nonoperating, adjust the chamber conditions to those specified for step 7 in table 504–II. After chamber conditions and the test item temperature have stabilized, the test item shall be operated at the highest specified input voltage for 4 cycles, each cycle consisting of the period of operation specified in table 504–II, followed by a 15–minute off period. The test item shall be checked for satisfactory operation during each period of operation and results recorded. Thermocouple readings shall be recorded every 10 minutes.

Step 8—With the test item nonoperating, adjust the chamber conditions to those specified for step 8 in table 504–II. After the chamber conditions and test item temperature have stabilized, the test item shall be operated at the highest specified input voltage for 4 cycles. Each cycle shall consist of the period of operation specified in table 504–II followed by 15–minute off period. The test item shall be checked for satisfactory operation during each period of operation and the results recorded. Thermocouple readings shall be recorded at the beginning and end of each operating period.

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Step 9—With the test item nonoperating, adjust the chamber temperature to that specified for step 9 of table 504–II. The test item temperature shall then be stabilized. The test item shall then be turned on and the altitude adjusted to that specified. Following chamber and test item temperature stabilization the test item shall be operated at the highest specified input voltage for that period of time specified in table 504–II. Thermocouple readings shall be recorded every 30 minutes. At the end of the specified operating period, continue to operate the test item until the equipment has been checked for satisfactory operation and results recorded.

Step 10—With the test item nonoperating, adjust the chamber temperature to that specified for step 10 in table 504–II. After the chamber and test item temperatures have stabilized, operate the test item at the highest specified input voltage for 4 cycles, each cycle consisting of the period of operation specified followed by a 15–minute off period. The test item shall be checked for satisfactory operation during each period of operation and results recorded. Thermocouple readings shall be recorded for every 10 minutes of operation.

Step 11—With the test item nonoperating, adjust the chamber temperature to that specified for step 11 in table 504–II. Following chamber temperature adjustment, the test item shall be turned on and the altitude adjusted to that specified. After the chamber conditions have stabilized, permit the test item to operate at the highest specified input voltage for the period of time specified in table 504–II. Thermocouple readings shall be recorded every 30 minutes. At the end of the specified operating period, continue to operate the test item at the specified conditions until an operational and performance check is made and the results recorded.

Step 12—With the test item nonoperating, stabilize the chamber and test item to those conditions specified for step 12 in table 504–II. After the chamber conditions and test item temperature have stabilized, operate the test item at the highest specified input voltage for 4 cycles, each cycle consisting of the period of operation specified in table 504–II followed by a 15–minute off period. The test item shall be checked for satisfactory operation during each period of operation and results recorded. Thermocouple readings shall be recorded for every 10 minutes of operation.

Step 13—With the test item nonoperating, stabilize the chamber and test item to those conditions specified for step 13 in table 504–II. Following stabilization the test item shall be operated at the highest specified input voltage for 4 cycles, each cycle consisting of the period of operation specified followed by a 15–minute off period. The test item shall be checked for satisfactory operation during each period of operation and thermocouple readings recorded at the beginning and end of each operating period.

Step 14—With the test item operating, adjust the chamber conditions to standard ambient conditions. When the chamber conditions have stabilized, an operational and performance check shall be made on the test item and results compared with the data obtained in section 3.2.1.

Note (e) In order to expedite the stabilization of test item temperatures, chamber temperatures other than those listed in table 504–II may be used.

Note (f) The steps listed herein include certain essential test points on the operational requirement curves of figures 504–1 through 504–4. These curves define the required temperature-altitude operational envelopes for the applicable classes of equipment. In addition to the essential test points listed any combination of conditions, in any sequence, within the design limitation envelopes as defined by the class of equipment or as modified by the detail specification, may be chosen as additional operational test points.

Note (g) Following those steps where an increase in temperature at low pressure is specified, the pressure may be increased to ambient before raising the temperature and then returned to the specified altitude following temperature stabilization.

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METHOD 505

SUNSHINE

1. PURPOSE. The sunshine test is conducted to determine the effect of radiant energy on aerospace and ground equipment. Sunshine causes heating of equipment and photo degradation such as fading of fabric colors, and checking of paints, natural rubber and plastics. The sunshine test is applicable to any item of equipment which may be exposed to solar radiation during service at the Earth's surface or in the lower atmosphere.

2. PROCEDURE.

Procedure I. The test item shall be placed in the test chamber in accordance with section 3.2.2 and exposed to radiant energy at the rate of 100 to 140 watts per square foot. Fifty to eighty-four watts per square foot shall be in wavelengths above 7,800 angstrom units and 4 to 8 watts per square foot shall be in wavelengths below 3,800 angstrom units. The test chamber temperature shall be maintained at 45°C (113°F) for a period of not less than 48 hours. At the conclusion of the exposure period, and with the temperature maintained as specified, the test item shall be operated and the results compared with the data obtained in section 3.2.1. The test item shall then be returned to room temperature and inspected in accordance with section 3.2.4.

1 watt hour = 3.413 btu.

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METHOD 506

RAIN

1. **PURPOSE.** The rain test is conducted to determine the efficiency of protective covers or cases designed to shield equipment from the elements. This test is applicable to all items of aerospace and ground equipment which may be exposed to rain under service conditions. Where a requirement exists for determining the effects of rain erosion on radomes, nose cones, etc., a rocket sled test facility or other such facility should be considered. Since any test procedure evolved would be contingent on requirements peculiar to the test item and the facility employed, a standardized test procedure for rain erosion is not included in this test method.

2. **PROCEDURE.**

Procedure I. The test item shall be placed in a rain chamber, equal to that specified in MIL-C-8811, and installed as specified in section 3.2.2. The rain chamber temperature shall be uncontrolled, except as regulated by water introduced as rain, throughout the test period. The test item shall be exposed to a simulated rainfall of 4 ± 1 inches per hour as measured at the surface of the test item by a U. S. Weather Bureau type gauge. The rainfall shall be produced by a means of a water spray nozzle of such design that the water is emitted in the form of droplets having a minimum diameter of 1.5 millimeters. The temperature of the water shall be uncontrolled provided the water supply temperature is between 11° and 35°C (51.8° and 95°F). The direction of rainfall shall be capable of variation up to 45° from the vertical. The rainfall shall be dispersed uniformly over the test area within the limits specified above. Each of the major sides of the test item shall be exposed to the simulated rainfall for a period of 30 minutes, for a total test duration of not less than 2 hours. At the conclusion of the test period the test item shall be removed from the test chamber, operated and the results compared with those obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1. The protective cover or case shall, where possible, then be removed and the test item inspected for compliance with section 3.2.4 with particular attention to evidence of water penetration, such as free water, swelling, or other deterioration.

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METHOD 507

HUMIDITY

1. **PURPOSE.** The humidity test is applicable to all items of aerospace and ground equipment and is conducted to determine the resistance of equipment to the effects of exposure to a warm, highly humid atmosphere such as is encountered in tropical areas. This is an accelerated environmental test, accomplished by the continuous exposure of the equipment to high relative humidity at an elevated temperature. These conditions impose a vapor pressure on the equipment under test which constitutes the force behind the moisture migration and penetration. Corrosion is one of the principal effects of humidity. Hygroscopic materials are sensitive to moisture and deteriorate rapidly under humid conditions. Absorption of moisture by many materials results in swelling, which destroys their functional utility and causes loss of physical strength and changes in other important mechanical properties. Insulating materials which absorb moisture may suffer degradation of their electrical properties.

2. **CHAMBER.** The chamber and accessories shall be constructed and arranged in such a manner as to avoid condensate dripping on the equipment under test. The chamber shall be vented to the atmosphere to prevent the build-up of vapor pressure. Relative humidity shall be determined from the dry bulb wet bulb thermometer comparison method. The wet bulb thermometer shall be installed at the internal mouth of the air inlet duct. The air velocity flowing across the wet bulb shall be not less than 900 feet per minute. Provisions shall be made for controlling the flow of air throughout the internal test chamber area where the velocity of air shall not exceed 150 feet per minute. Distilled or deionized water having a pH value between 6.5 and 7.5 at 25°C (77°F) shall be used to obtain the specified humidity.

3. **PROCEDURE.**

Procedure I. Humidity Cycling. The test item shall be placed in the test chamber in accordance with section 3.2.2. Prior to starting the test the chamber temperature shall be between 20° and 38°C (68° and 100°F) with uncontrolled humidity. The temperature and relative humidity shall then be gradually raised to 71°C (160°F) and 95 percent respectively over a period of 2 hours. These conditions shall be maintained for a period of not less than 6 hours. With the relative humidity maintained at 95 percent the chamber temperature shall then be gradually reduced to 20° to 38°C (68° to 100°F) over a period of not less than 16 hours. This constitutes 1 cycle. The number of continuous cycles shall be 10 for a total test time of not less than 240 hours. At the conclusion of the test, the test item shall be removed from the chamber and returned to room ambient conditions. Excess moisture may be removed by turning the test item upside down or by wiping external surfaces only. The test item shall then be operated, the results compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1, and inspected in accordance with section 3.2.4 within 1 hour.

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METHOD 508

FUNGUS

1. **PURPOSE.** The fungus test is conducted to determine the resistance of aerospace and ground equipment to fungi. Fungi secrete enzymes which can destroy most organic substances and many of their derivatives. They can also destroy many minerals.

Typical materials which will support and are damaged by fungi are:

Cotton	Leather
Wood	Paper and Cardboard
Linen	Cork
Cellulose Nitrate	Hair and Felts
Regenerated Cellulose	Lens Coating Materials

2. **PREPARATION OF SPORE SUSPENSION.** Four groups of fungi are listed in table 508-I. One species of fungus from each group shall be used.

TABLE 508-I

Group	Organism	American Type Culture Collection Number Note 1	Quartermaster Number Note 2
I	Chaetomium globosum Myrothecium verrucaria	6205 9095	459 460
II	Memneniella echinata Aspergillus niger	9597 6275	1225 458
III	Aspergillus flavus Aspergillus terreus	10836 10690	1223 82j
IV	Penicillium citrinum Penicillium ochrochloron	9849 9112	1226 477

Note 1. Source. American Type Culture Collection
2112 M Street, N. W.
Washington 6, D. C.

Note 2. Source. Mycology Laboratory, PRD, Quartermaster Research and Engineering Center
Natick, Massachusetts

In preparing the spore suspension, distilled water having a pH value between 5.8 and 7.2 at a temperature between 22° and 32°C (72° and 89°F) shall be utilized. Approximately 10ml. of sterile distilled water shall be introduced directly into each tube culture of the fungus and the fungal spores brought into suspension by vigorous shaking or by gentle rubbing of the spore layer with an inoculating loop without disturbing the agar surface. This process shall be repeated for each species of fungus. The separate spore suspensions from the four types of fungi shall be mixed together to provide a composite suspension. Actively growing cultures between 7 to 21 days old after initial inoculation shall be used for the preparation of the spore suspension. After preparation, the spore suspension will not be kept for more than a 24-hour period at temperatures from 22° to 32°C (72° to 89°F) or not more than 48 hours at temperatures from 2° to 7°C (35° to 45°F).

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3. PROCEDURE.

Procedure I. This procedure shall be used for complete assemblies or large pieces of material which cannot be cut or reduced to sample size. The equipment shall be placed in a mold chamber, equal to that specified in MIL–C–9452, and installed as specified in section 3.2.2. The internal test chamber temperature shall be raised to 30° ± 2°C (86° ± 3.6°F) at 95 ± 5 percent relative humidity and maintained throughout the test period. The test item shall be sprayed with the suspension of mixed spores. To insure viability of the organism, a known nutrient material inoculated with the same spore suspension used to spray the test item shall be placed in the test chamber. The test period shall be not less than 28 days. At the end of this period the test item shall be removed from the test chamber and inspected in accordance with section 3.2.4. If so specified in the detail specification the test item shall be operated and the results compared with those obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1.

Procedure II. This procedure shall be used for materials which can be cut or reduced to a size suitable for testing in a petri dish. The test shall be performed in accordance with specification MIL–F–8261, except that the spore suspension shall be prepared as specified in paragraph 2 of this test method. A test period of not less than 14 days shall be used.

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METHOD 509

SALT FOG

1. **PURPOSE.** The salt fog test is conducted to determine the resistance of aerospace and ground equipment to the effects of a salt atmosphere. Damage to be expected from exposure to salt fog is primarily corrosion of metals, although in some instances salt deposits may result in clogging or binding of moving parts. In order to accelerate this test and thereby reduce testing time, the specified concentration of moisture and salt is greater than is found in service. The test is applicable to any equipment exposed to salt fog conditions in service.

2. **APPARATUS.** The apparatus used in the salt fog test shall include the following:

a. Exposure chamber with racks for supporting test items

b. Salt solution reservoir

c. Means for atomizing salt solution, including suitable nozzles and compressed air supply

d. Chamber-heating means and control

e. Means for humidifying the air at a temperature above the chamber temperature

2.1 Chamber. The chamber and all accessories shall be made of material that will not affect the corrosiveness of the fog such as glass, hard rubber, plastic, or kiln dried wood, other than plywood. In addition, all parts which come in contact with test items shall be of materials that will not cause electrolytic corrosion. The chamber and accessories shall be constructed and arranged so that there is no direct impingement of the fog or dripping of the condensate on the test items, that the fog circulates freely about all test items to the same degree, and that no liquid which has come in contact with the test items returns to the salt-solution reservoir. The chamber shall be properly vented to prevent pressure build-up and allow uniform distribution of salt fog.

2.2 Atomizers. The atomizers used shall be of such design and construction as to produce a finely divided, wet, dense fog. Atomizing nozzles shall be made of material that is nonreactive to the salt solution.

2.3 Air Supply. The compressed air entering the atomizers shall be essentially free from all impurities, such as oil and dirt. Means shall be provided to humidify and warm the compressed air as required to meet the operating conditions. The air pressure shall be suitable to produce a finely divided dense fog with the atomizer or atomizers used. To insure against clogging the atomizers by salt deposition, the air should have a relative humidity of at least 85 percent at the point of release from the nozzle. A satisfactory method is to pass the air in very fine bubbles through a tower containing heated water. The temperature of the water should be 35°C (95°F) and often higher. The permissible water temperature increases with increasing volume of air and with decreasing heat insulation of the chamber and temperature of the chamber's surroundings. It should not exceed a value above which an excess of moisture is introduced into the chamber (for example, 43°C (109°F) at an air pressure of 12 psi) or a value which makes it impossible to meet the requirement for operating temperature.

3. **PREPARATION OF SALT SOLUTION.** The salt used shall be sodium chloride containing on the dry basis not more than 0.1 percent of sodium iodide and not more than 0.2 percent of total impurities. Unless otherwise specified a 5 ± 1 percent solution shall be prepared by dissolving 5 ± 1 parts by weight of salt in 95 parts by weight of water containing not more than 200 parts per million of total solids. The solution shall be adjusted to and maintained at a specific gravity of from 1.023 to 1.037. In order to determine if the percent of sodium chloride in the solution falls within the specified range refer to figure 509-1 utilizing the measured temperature and density of the salt solution.

3.1 Adjustment of pH. The pH of the salt solution shall be so maintained that the solution atomized at $35° \begin{smallmatrix}+1° \\ -2°\end{smallmatrix}C$ ($95 \begin{smallmatrix}+2° \\ -3°\end{smallmatrix}F$) and collected by the method specified in paragraph 4.3 of this test method will be in the pH range of 6.5 to 7.2. Only diluted C. P. hydrochloric acid or C. P. sodium hydroxide shall be used to adjust the pH. The pH measurement shall be made electrometrically using a glass electrode with a saturated potassium chloride bridge or by a colorimetric method such as bromothymol blue, provided the results are equivalent to those obtained with the electrometric method. The pH shall be measured when preparing each new batch of solution and as specified in paragraph 4.4 of this test method.

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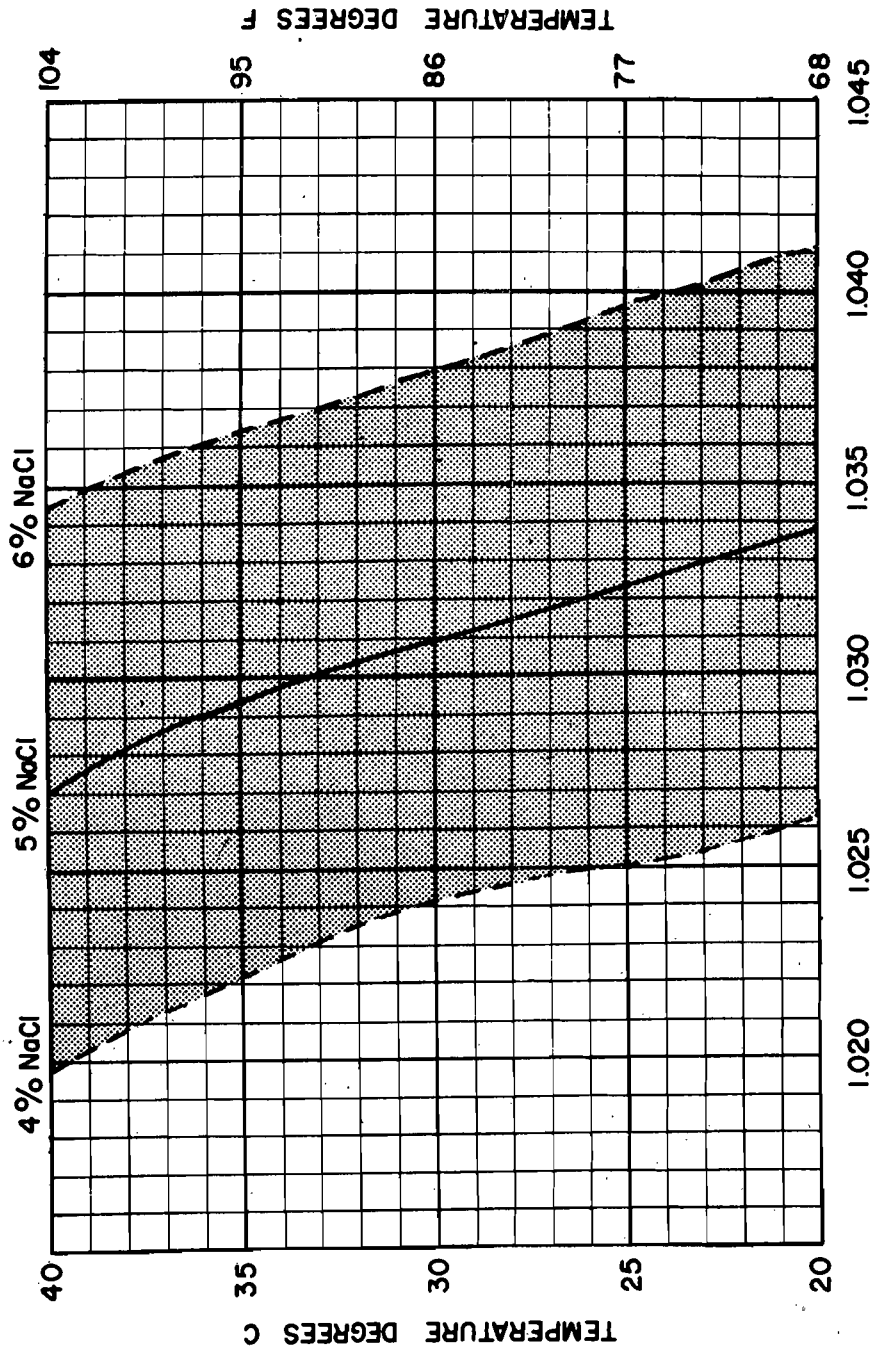
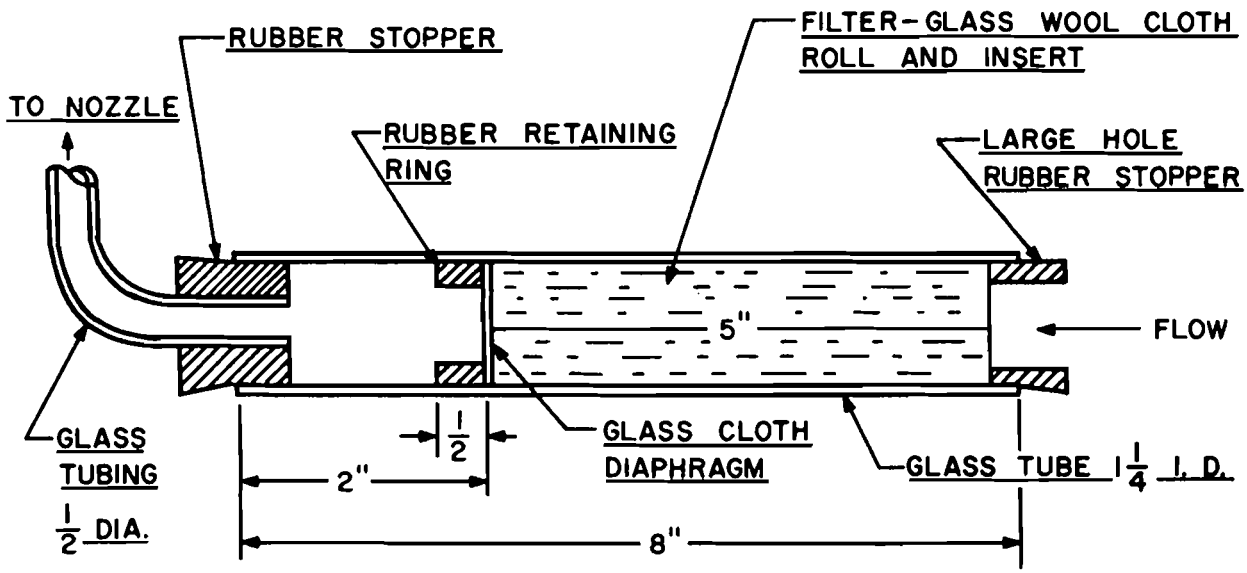


Figure 509-1. Variations of specific gravity of salt (NaCl) solution with temperature.

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SALT SOLUTION FILTER
FIGURE 509—2

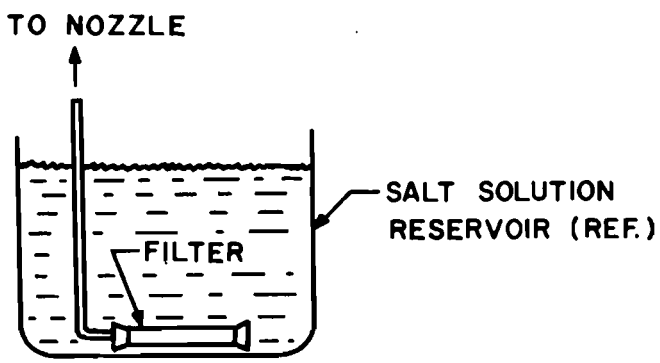


Figure 509–3. Location of salt solution filter.

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3.2 **Filter.** A filter fabricated of noncorrosive materials similar to that shown in figure 509–2 shall be provided in the supply line and immersed in the salt solution reservoir in a manner such as that illustrated in figure 509–3.

4. TEST CHAMBER OPERATING CONDITIONS.

4.1 **Temperature.** The test shall be conducted with a temperature in the exposure zone maintained at 35° $^{+1°}_{-2°}$C (95° $^{+2°}_{-3°}$F). Satisfactory methods for controlling the temperature accurately are by housing the apparatus in a properly controlled constant temperature room, by thoroughly insulating the apparatus and preheating the air to the proper temperature prior to atomization, or by jacketing the apparatus and controlling the temperature of the water or of the air used in the jacket. The use of immersion heaters within the chamber for the purpose of maintaining the temperature within the exposure zone is prohibited.

4.2 **Atomization.** Suitable atomization has been obtained in chambers having a volume of less than 12 cubic feet with the following conditions:

a. Nozzle pressure between 12 and 18 pounds per square inch
b. Orifices between 0.02 and 0.03 inch in diameter
c. Atomization of approximately 3 quarts of salt solution per 10 cubic feet of chamber volume per 24 hours

When using large size chambers having a volume considerably in excess of 12 cubic feet, the conditions specified may require modification to meet the requirements for operating conditions.

4.3 **Placement of Salt Fog Collection Receptacles.** The salt fog conditions maintained in all parts of the exposure zone shall be such that a clean fog collecting receptacle placed at any point in the exposure zone will collect from 0.5 to 3 milliliters of solution per hour for each 80 square centimeters of horizontal collecting area (10 centimeters diameter) based on an average test of at least 16 hours. A minimum of two receptacles shall be used, one placed nearest to any nozzle and one farthest from all nozzles. Receptacles shall be placed so that they are not shielded by test items and so no drops of solution from test items or other sources will be collected.

4.4 **Measurement of Salt Solution.** The solution, collected in the manner specified in 4.3, shall have the sodium chloride content and pH specified in paragraph 3 when measured at a temperature of 35° $^{+1°}_{-2°}$C (95° $^{+2°}_{-3°}$F). The salt solution from all collection receptacles used can be combined to provide that quantity required for the measurements specified.

4.4.1 **Measurement of Sodium Chloride Content.** The solution, maintained at the specified temperature, can be measured in a graduate of approximately 2.5 centimeters inside diameter. A small laboratory type hydrometer will be required for measurement within this volume.

4.4.2 **Measurement of pH.** The pH shall be measured as specified in paragraph 3.1 of this test method.

4.4.3 **Time of Measurements.** The measurement of both sodium chloride and pH shall be made at the following specified times:

a. For salt fog chambers in continuous use the measurements shall be made following each test.
b. For salt fog chambers that are used infrequently a 24–hour test run shall be accomplished followed by the measurements. The test item shall not be exposed to this test run.

5. **PREPARATION OF TEST ITEM.** The test item shall be given a minimum of handling, particularly on the significant surfaces, and shall be prepared for test immediately before exposure. Unless otherwise specified, uncoated metallic or metallic coated devices shall be thoroughly cleaned of oil, dirt, and grease as necessary until the surface is free from water break. The cleaning methods shall not include the use of corrosive solvents nor solvents which deposit either corrosive or protective films, nor the use of abrasives other than a paste of pure magnesium oxide. Test items having an organic coating shall not be solvent cleaned. Those portions of test items which come in contact with the support and, unless otherwise specified in the case of coated devices or samples, cut edges and surfaces not required to be coated, shall be protected with a suitable coating of wax or similar substance impervious to moisture.

6. PROCEDURE.

Procedure I. The test item shall be placed in the test chamber in accordance with section 3.2.2 and exposed to the salt spray for a period of not less than 48 hours. At the end of the test period the test item shall be operated and the results compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1. Salt deposits resulting from the test may be removed by such methods specified in the detail specification prior to operation of the test item. The test item shall then be inspected in accordance with section 3.2.4.

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METHOD 510

SAND AND DUST

1. **PURPOSE.** The sand and dust test is conducted to determine the resistance of aerospace and ground equipment to blowing fine sand and dust particles. Because of its abrasive character, sand and dust may affect items having moving parts where sand may enter. It may also cause the parts to bind, and may interfere with electrical contacts. Dust particles may also form nuclei for condensation of moisture, thus aiding in corrosion. Equipment may malfunction due to clogging of air filters.

2. **CHARACTERISTICS OF SAND AND DUST.** Sand and dust used in the test shall be of angular structure and shall have characteristics as follows:

a. 100 percent of the sand and dust shall pass through a 100-mesh screen, U. S. Standard Sieve Series.

b. 98 ± 2 percent of the sand and dust shall pass through a 140-mesh screen, U. S. Standard Sieve Series.

c. 90 ± 2 percent of the sand and dust shall pass through a 200-mesh screen, U. S. Standard Sieve Series.

d. 75 ± 2 percent of the sand and dust shall pass through a 325-mesh screen, U. S. Standard Sieve Series.

e. Chemical analysis of the dust shall be as follows:

SUBSTANCE	PERCENT BY WEIGHT
SiO_2	97 to 99
Fe_2O_3	0 to 2
Al_2O_3	0 to 2
TiO_2	0 to 2
MgO	0 to 1
Inorganic Losses	0 to 1

The sand and dust is commercially known as "140-mesh silica flour." Sand and dust (140-mesh silica flour) produced by the Fenton Foundry Supply Company, Dayton, Ohio, and Ottawa Silica Company, Ottawa, Illinois, or equal, is satisfactory for use in the performance of these tests.

3. **PROCEDURE.**

Procedure I. The test item shall be placed in a test chamber equal to that specified in MIL-C-9436, in accordance with section 3.2.2. The sand and dust density shall be raised to and maintained at 0.1 to 0.25 gram per cubic foot as measured at least three different locations within the test area utilizing approved collection devices. The relative humidity shall not exceed 30 percent at any time during the test. The internal temperature of the test chamber shall be maintained at 25°C (77°F) for a period of not less than 2 hours with the air velocity through the test chamber at 100 to 500 feet per minute. Following this 2-hour period the temperature shall be raised to and maintained at 71°C (160°F). These conditions shall be maintained for not less than 2 hours. At the end of this exposure period, the test item shall be removed from the test chamber and allowed to cool to room temperature. Accumulated dust shall be removed from the test item by brushing, wiping, or shaking, care being taken to avoid introduction of additional dust into the test item. Under no circumstances shall dust be removed by either air blast or vacuum cleaning. The test item shall then be operated, the results compared with those obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1, and inspected in accordance with section 3.2.4. In the performance of this inspection, test items containing bearings, grease seals, lubricants, etc., shall be carefully examined for the presence of sand and dust deposits.

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METHOD 511

EXPLOSION

1. **PURPOSE.** The explosion-proof test is conducted to determine the ability of aerospace and ground equipment to operate in the presence of an explosive mixture without creating an explosion or to contain an explosion occurring inside the equipment. Since aerospace equipments are operating in ever changing potentially explosive atmospheres due to the flight profile of the aerospace vehicle, the equipments, when being laboratory tested, must operate in the presence of the optimum fuel-air mixture which requires the least amount of energy for ignition. The equipment igniting energy may be produced electrically, thermally or chemically. The test procedures described herein are intended to serve several purposes. Procedure I is intended for determining the explosion producing characteristics of aerospace equipment not hermetically sealed and not contained in cases designed to prevent flame and explosion propagation. Ground equipment used in or near aerospace vehicles shall also be tested in accordance with this procedure except that the specified altitude survey need be conducted only to 10,000 feet. Procedure II is intended for determining the explosion and flame arresting characteristics of equipment cases designed for that purpose.

2. **APPARATUS.** An explosion-proof test chamber equal to that specified in MIL-C-9435 shall be used.

3. **FUEL.** The types of fuel selected shall be determined from the operational use and requirements of the equipment. Gasoline fuel shall be as specified in MIL-G-5572. Jet fuel shall be as specified in MIL-J-5624.

3.1 Calculation of Fuel-Air Vapor Ratio. In illustration of the procedure for calculating the weight of 100/130 octane gasoline required to produce the desired 13 to 1 air-vapor ratio, the following sample problem is presented:

Required information:

a. Chamber air temperature during test: 27°C(80°F).

b. Fuel temperature: 24°C (75°F).

c. Specific gravity of fuel at: 16°C (60°F): 0.704

d. Test Altitude: 20,000 feet ($P = 6.75$ lbs/in.^{2})

e. Air-vapor ratio (desired): 13 to 1

Step 1. Employing the following equation, calculate the apparent air vapor ratio:

$$AAV = \frac{AV\ (desired)}{1.04\left(\frac{P}{14.696}\right) - .04} = \frac{13}{1.04\left(\frac{6.75}{14.696}\right) - .04} = 29.68$$

Where —

AAV = Apparent air ,vapor ratio

AV = Desired air vapor ratio

P = Pressure equivalent of altitude, lbs/in.^{2}

At or above 10,000 feet altitude, with chamber air temperature above 16°C (60°F) and at AV ratio of 5 or greater, air vapor ratio = air fuel ratio (AF) for 100/130 octane fuel. Since the conditions of the explosion test under consideration will always be well above these values AV will equal AF in all cases.

Step 2. Since AV = AF, use figure 511-1 to determine weight of air and divide by AAV to obtain uncorrected weight of fuel required.

$$W_{FU} = \frac{Wa}{29.68} = \frac{3.455}{29.68} = 0.116 \text{ lbs, fuel weight (uncorrected).}$$

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Figure 511–1 pertains to a specific test chamber and may not be used for all such test facilities. It is utilized herein for illustration of the method of employment only. Each test chamber must have its own chamber volume chart.

Step 3. Knowing fuel temperature and specific gravity at 16°C (60°F) use figure 511–2 to determine specific gravity at given temperature.

Step 4. Using figure 511–3 read from specific gravity determined under Step 3 for the correction factor k. Apply factor.

$W_{FC} = W_{FU}{}^{xk} = 0.116 \times 1.01 = 0.117$ lbs, fuel weight (corrected).

The equipment used to vaporize the fuel for use in the explosion-proof test should be so designed that a small quantity of air and fuel vapor will be heated together to a temperature such that the fuel vapor will not condense as it is drawn from the vaporizer into the chamber.

---

4. PROCEDURE.

Procedure I.

Preparation for Test.

a. The test item shall be installed in the test chamber in accordance with section 3.2.2 and in such a manner that normal electrical operation is possible and mechanical controls may be operated through the pressure seals from the exterior of the chamber. External covers of the test item shall be removed or loosened to facilitate the penetration of the explosive mixture. Large test items may be tested one or more units at a time by extending electrical connections through the cable port to the balance of the associated equipment located externally.

b. The test item shall be operated to determine that it is functioning properly and to observe the location of any sparking or high temperature components which may constitute potential explosion hazards.

c. Mechanical loads on drive assemblies and servomechanical and electrical loads on switches and relays may be simulated when necessary if proper precaution is given to duplicating the normal load in respect to torque, voltage, current, inductive reactance, etc. In all instances it shall be considered preferable to operate the test item as it normally functions in the system during service use.

Performance of Test.

The test shall be conducted as follows at simulated test altitudes of ground level to 5,000 feet, 10,000 feet (10,000 feet maximum for ground equipment, 20,000 feet, 30,000 feet, 40,000 feet and 50,000 feet. Pressures for altitudes are given in the ARDC Model Atmosphere, 1959.

Step 1. The test chamber shall be sealed and the ambient temperature within shall be raised to 71 ± 3°C (160 ± 5°F), or to the maximum temperature to which the test item is designed to operate (if lower than 71°C or 160°F). The temperature of the test item and the chamber walls shall be permitted to rise to within 11°C or 20°F of that of the chamber ambient air, prior to introduction of the explosive mixture.

Step 2. The internal test chamber pressure shall be reduced sufficiently to simulate an altitude approximately 10,000 feet above the desired test altitude. The weight of fuel necessary to produce an air-vapor ratio of 13 to 1 at the desired test altitude shall be determined from consideration of chamber volume, fuel temperature and specific gravity, chamber air and wall temperature, test altitude, etc. (see para. 3.1 of this test method). A time of 3 ± 1 minutes shall be allowed for introduction and vaporization of the fuel. Air shall be admitted into the chamber until a simulated altitude of 5,000 feet above the test altitude is attained.

Step 3. Operation of the test item shall at this time be commenced, all making and breaking electrical contacts being actuated. If high temperature components are present, a warmup time of 15 minutes shall be permitted. If no explosion results, air shall be admitted into the chamber so as to steadily reduce the altitude down past the desired test altitude to an elevation 5,000 feet below that altitude. The operation of the test item shall be continuous throughout this period of altitude reduction and all making and breaking electrical contacts shall be operated as frequently as deemed practicable.

Step 4. If by the time the simulated altitude has been reduced to 5,000 feet below the test altitude, no explosion has occurred as a result of operation of the test

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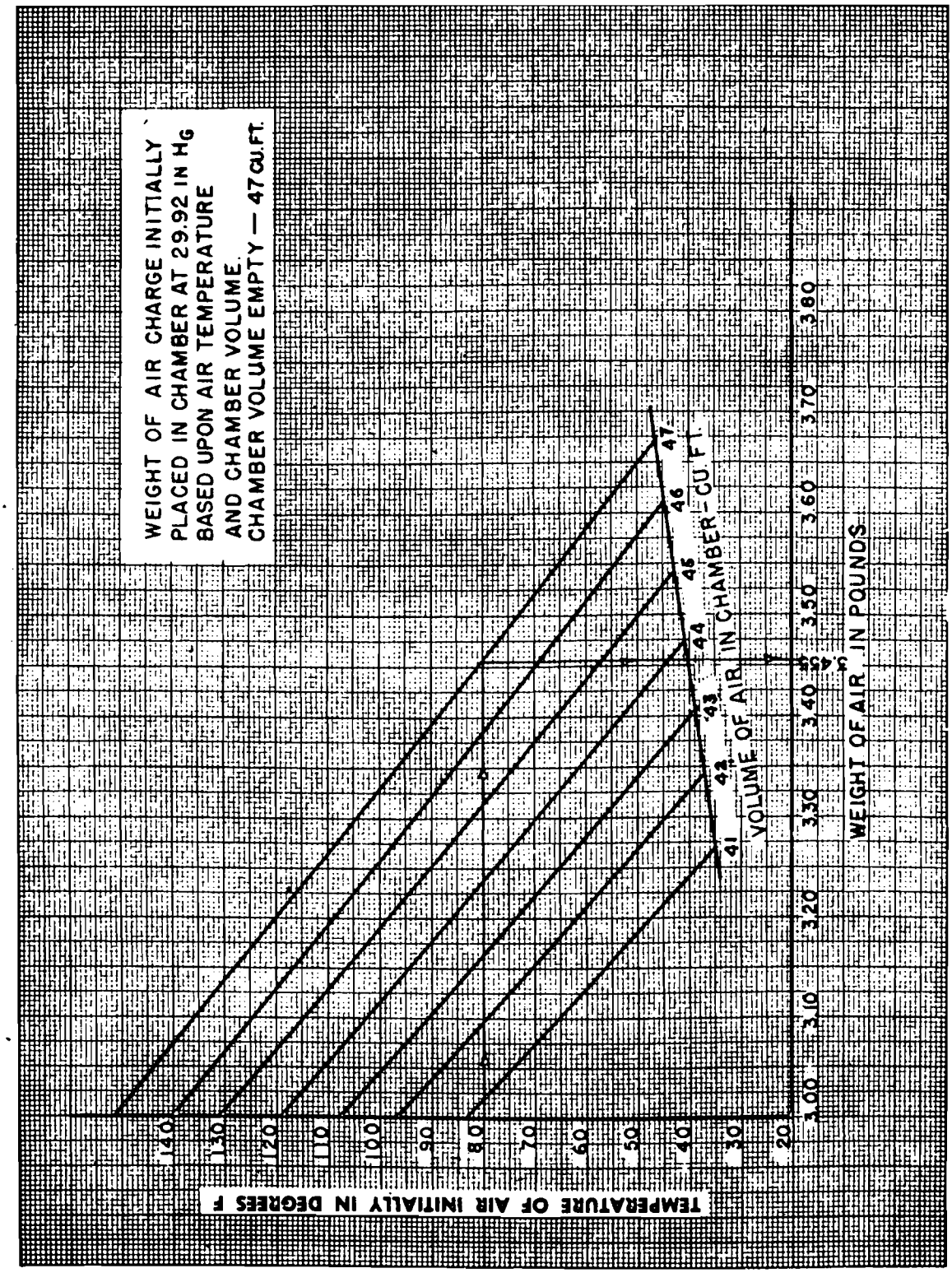


Figure 511-1. Weight of air.

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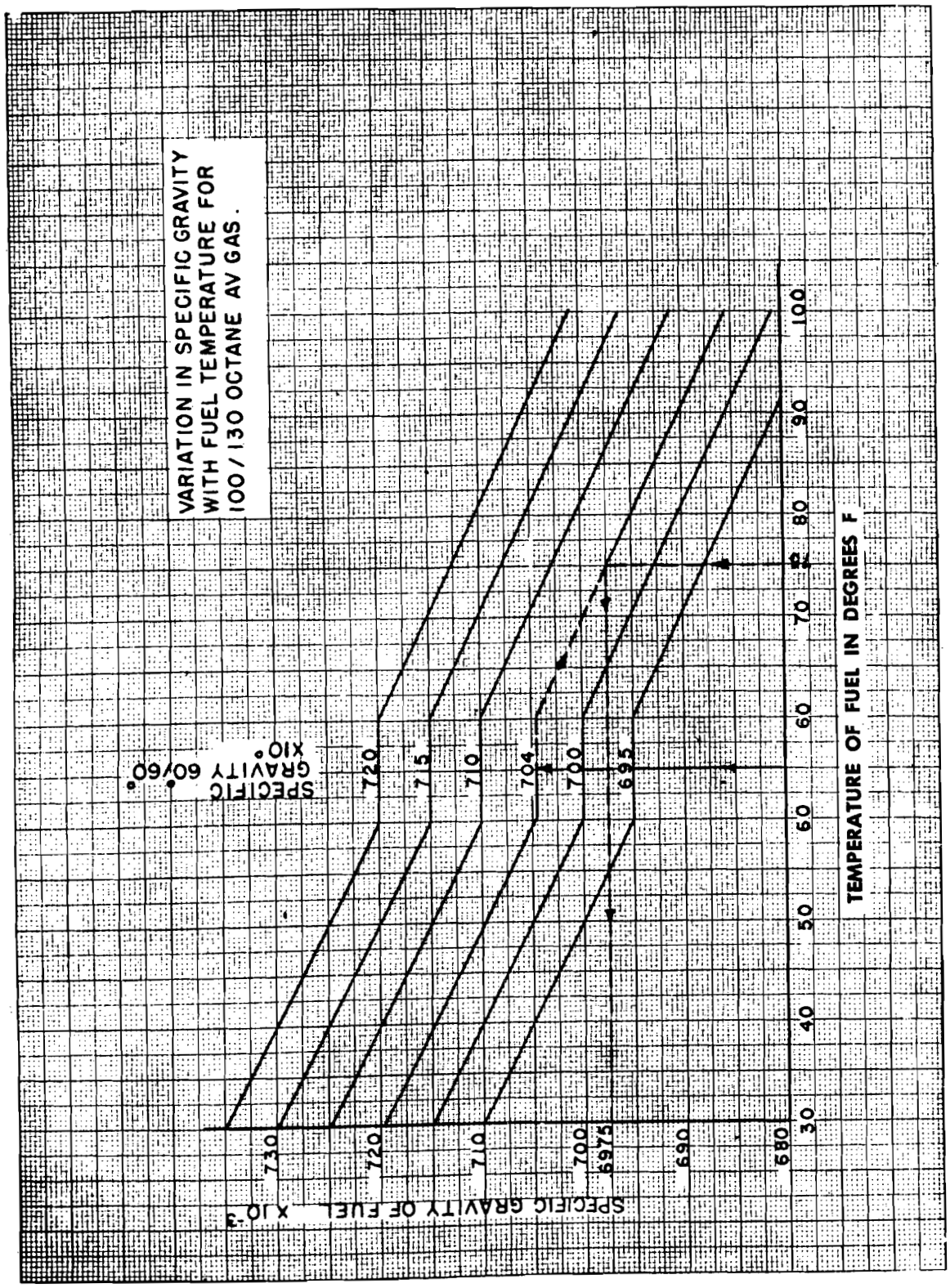


Figure 511-2. Specific gravity of fuel at a given temperature.

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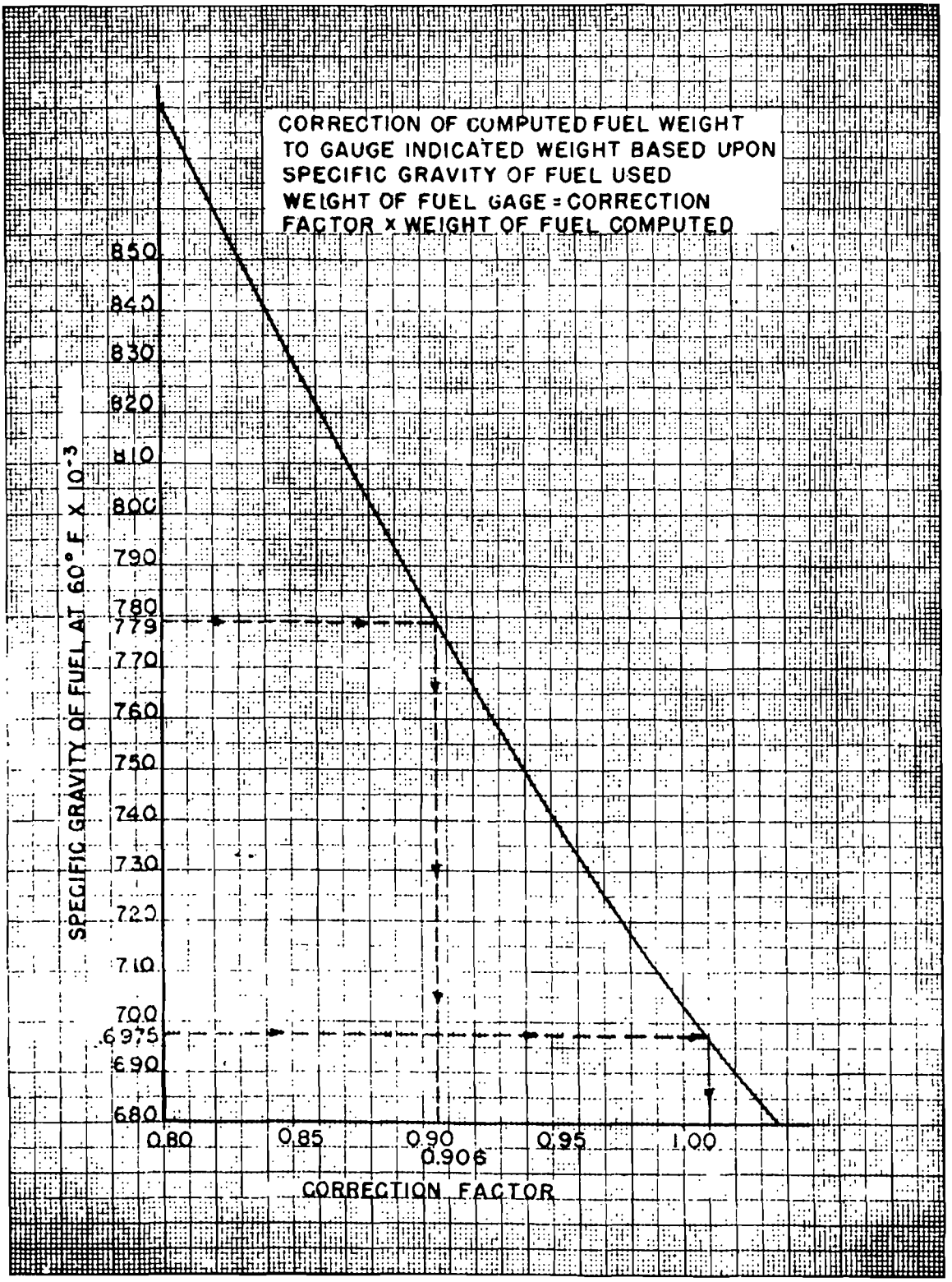


Figure 511–3. Correction factor.

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item, the potential explosiveness of the air-vapor mixture shall be verified. If the air-vapor mixture is not found to be explosive, the test shall be considered void and the entire procedure repeated.

Failure Criteria

If the item causes explosion at any of the test altitudes it shall be considered to have failed to pass the test and no further trials need be attempted.

Procedure II

Preparation for Test.

a. Preparation of Test Item Case or Item Enclosure.

When necessary the test item case or item enclosures shall be prepared for explosion-proof testing by drilling and tapping openings in the case or enclosure for inlet and outlet hose connections to the fuel vapor air mixture circulation system and for mounting a spark gap device. The case volume shall not be altered by more than ±5 percent by any modification to facilitate the introduction of explosive vapor.

b. **Hose Installation.** When inserting a hose from a blower, adequate precaution must be taken to prevent ignition of the ambient mixture by backfire or the release of pressure through the supply hose.

c. **Spark Gap Device.** A spark gap device for igniting the explosive mixture within the case or enclosure shall be provided and is used only to insure the presence of an explosive mixture inside the test item case. The case or enclosure may be drilled and tapped for the spark gap device or the spark gap device may be mounted internally.

d. The case or enclosure with either the test item or a model of the test item of the same volume and configuration in position within the case or enclosure shall be installed in the explosion chamber as specified in section 3.2.2.

Performance of Test.

The test shall be accomplished three times at altitudes between ground level and 5,000 feet as follows:

Step 1. The chamber shall be sealed and the internal pressure reduced sufficiently to simulate an altitude between ground level and 5,000 feet. The ambient chamber temperature shall be at least 25°C (77°F). An explosive mixture within the chamber shall be obtained by following the procedure set forth in Procedure I herein.

Step 2. The internal case ignition source shall be energized in order to cause an explosion within the case. The occurrence of an explosion within the case may be detected by use of a thermocouple inserted in the case and connected to a sensitive galvanometer outside the test chamber. If ignition of the mixture within the case does not occur immediately, the test shall be considered void and shall be repeated with a new explosive charge.

Step 3. At least five internal case explosions shall be accomplished at the test altitude selected. If the case tested is small (not in excess of one-fiftieth of the test chamber volume) and if the reaction within the case upon ignition is of an explosive nature without continued burning of the mixture as it circulates into the case, more than one internal case explosion but not more than five may be produced without recharging the entire chamber. Ample time must be allowed between internal case explosions for replacement of burnt gases with fresh explosive mixture, within the case. If the internal case explosions produced did not cause a main chamber explosion, the explosiveness of the fuel-air mixture in the main chamber shall be verified. If the air-vapor mixture in the main chamber is not found to be explosive the test shall be considered void and the entire procedure repeated.

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METHOD 512

IMMERSION (LEAKAGE)

1. **PURPOSE.** The immersion test is a gross leak test and is conducted to determine the integrity of hermetic and gasket seals, and is applicable to all items of aerospace and ground equipment incorporating such features.

2. **PROCEDURE.**

Procedure I. This procedure shall be used for hermetically sealed units and for units having bi-directional type gaskets. The test item shall be immersed in a suitable liquid, such as glycerine, diethylene glycol, or a saturated solution of sodium chloride in tap water. The liquid temperature shall be uncontrolled if the supply temperature is betwen 11° and 25°C (52° to 77°F). The absolute pressure of the air above the liquid shall then be reduced to approximately 1 inch of mercury and maintained for 1 minute, or until air bubbles substantially cease to be given off by the liquid, whichever is the longer. The absolute pressure shall then be increased to 2½ inches of mercury. Any bubbles coming from within the test item case or device shall be considered as leakage. Bubbles that are the result of entrapped air on the various exterior parts shall not be considered as leaks.

Procedure II. This procedure shall be used for units employing gaskets designed for unidirectional flow of either gas or liquid. Using the same conditions of liquid and temperature specified in procedure I, the test item, when placed in any possible position and with no portion of it less than 3 feet below the liquid surface, shall show no evidence of liquid penetration after being immersed for a period of 12 hours.

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METHOD 513
ACCELERATION

1. **PURPOSE.** The acceleration test is conducted to determine structural soundness and satisfactory performance of aerospace equipment in a field of steady state acceleration other than gravity.

2. **SCOPE.** The equipment to be tested shall be subjected to both the structural and the operational test unless otherwise specified by the detail specification.

3. **APPARATUS.** Either of two facilities may be utilized for acceleration tests; a centrifuge or a track and rocket sled facility. A centrifuge of adequate size is recommended for all structural and most operational tests because of the convenience and ease of control. However, the performance of space oriented equipments such as gyros, space control platforms, etc., are difficult to test on a centrifuge even when a counter-rotating fixture is employed. A rocket sled run is advantageous where strictly linear acceleration is required.

4. **MOUNTING OF TEST ITEM.** Normally the location of the test item on the centrifuge, with reference to the G level established for the test, shall be determined from a measurement taken from the center of the centrifuge to the geometric center of the test item. Should any point of the test item nearest the center of the centrifuge experience less than 90 percent of the specified G level the test item shall be moved outward on the radius of the centrifuge until not less than 90 percent of the specified G level is obtained.

5. **PROCEDURE.**

Procedure I. Structural Test. The test item shall be installed on the acceleration apparatus in accordance with section 3.2.2 by its normal mounting means. The test item shall be nonoperating during the test. The G level to be applied to the test item is contingent on two factors; the forward acceleration G level of the vehicle, and the orientation of the test item within the vehicle. When the forward acceleration G level of the vehicle **is known** and, when the position of the test item in the vehicle **is known**, the test level shall be determined as follows:

DIRECTION OF MOTION	
Fore	$1.5 \times A = G$ Test Level
Aft	$0.5 \times A = G$ Test Level
Up	$0.75 \times A = G$ Test Level
Down	$2.25 \times A = G$ Test Level
Lateral	$1.0 \times A = G$ Test Level

Where: A = The highest possible forward acceleration assumed, calculated or measured.

When the position of the test item in the vehicle **is unknown**, the test level shall be determined as follows:

$$2.25 \times A = G \text{ Test Level.}$$

When the forward acceleration G level of the vehicle is **not known**, and the position of the test item in the vehicle **is known**, the test level shall be determined by the vehicle category as specified in table 513-I.

TABLE 513-I
G Levels for Structural Test

Vehicle Category		Direction				
		Fore	Aft	Up	Down	Lateral
Aircraft and Helicopters		9.0	3.0	4.5	13.5	6.0
Manned Aerospace Vehicles		9.0 to 18.0	3.0 to 6.0	4.5 to 9.0	13.5 to 27.0	6.0 to 12.0
Air Launched Missiles		13.5 to 45.0	4.5 to 15.0	7.0 to 23.0	20.0 to 23.0	4.5 to 30.0
Ground Launched Missiles	Liquid Boosters	9.0 to 18.0	3.0 to 6.0	—	—	6.0 to 12.0
	Solid Boosters	9.0 to 45.0	3.0 to 15.0	—	—	6.0 to 30.0

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When both the forward acceleration G level of the vehicle and the position of the test item in the vehicle are **unknown** the highest G level in table 513-I for the particular vehicle category selected shall be utilized. The test shall then commence. The G level determined for the test shall be applied along at least three mutually perpendicular axes in two opposite directions along each axis. The test time duration in each direction shall be at least one minute following centrifuge stabilization. A test time of one minute is usually sufficient to determine structural soundness, however, the test time may be increased at the option of the procuring activity. At the conclusion of the test the test item shall be operated and the results compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1. The test item shall then be inspected as specified in section 3.2.4.

Procedure II. Operational Test. The test item shall be installed on the acceleration apparatus in accordance with section 3.2.2 by its normal mounting means. The test item shall be operating during the test. The G level to be applied to the test item is contingent on two factors; the forward acceleration G level of the vehicle, and the position of the test item within the vehicle. When the forward acceleration G level of the vehicle is **known** and, when the position of the test item in the vehicle is **known**, the test level shall be determined as follows:

DIRECTION OF MOTION

Fore	$1.1 \times A = G$ Test Level
Aft	$0.33 \times A = G$ Test Level
Up	$0.5 \times A = G$ Test Level
Down	$1.5 \times A = G$ Test Level
Lateral	$0.66 \times A = G$ Test Level

Where: A = The highest possible forward acceleration assumed, calculated or measured.

When the position of the test item in the vehicle is **unknown**, the test level shall be determined as follows:

$1.5 \times A = G$ Test Level

When the forward acceleration G level of the vehicle is **not known**, and the position of the test item in the vehicle is **known**, the test level shall be determined by the vehicle category as specified in table 513-II.

TABLE 513-II

G Levels for Operational Test

Vehicle Category		Direction				
		Fore	Aft	Up	Down	Lateral
Aircraft and Helicopters		6.0	2.0	3.0	9.0	4.0
Manned Aerospace Vehicles		6.0 to 12.0	2.0 to 4.0	3.0 to 6.0	9.0 to 18.0	4.0 to 8.0
Air Launched Missiles		9.0 to 30.0	3.0 to 10.0	4.5 to 15.0	13.5 to 45.0	6.0 to 20.0
Ground Launched Missiles	Liquid Boosters	6.0 to 12.0	2.0 to 4.0	—	—	4.0 to 8.0
	Solid Boosters	6.0 to 30.0	2.0 to 10.0	—	—	4.0 to 20.0

When both the forward acceleration G level of the vehicle and the position of the test item in the vehicle **are unknown**, 150 percent of the G level in the "fore" direction column of table 513-II for the particular vehicle category selected shall be utilized. The test shall then commence. The G level determined for the test shall be applied along at least three mutually perpendicular axes in two opposite directions along each axis. The test time duration in each direction shall be at least one minute following centrifuge stabilization. A test time of one minute is usually sufficient to determine proper operation, however, the test time may be increased at the option of the procuring activity. The test item shall be operated before, during and at the conclusion of the test, and the results compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1. The test item shall then be inspected as specified in section 3.2.4.

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METHOD 514

VIBRATION

1. **PURPOSE.** The vibration test is conducted to determine that aerospace and ground equipment is constructed to withstand expected dynamic stresses at pronounced vibration susceptible frequencies and that performance degradations or malfunctions will not be produced by the service vibration environment.

2. **SCOPE.** The tests specified herein are established for equipment to be used in a variety of military applications. Table 514–I, Vibration Selection Chart, provides a convenient means for selecting test requirements. This table is divided into two major sections. The first section, captioned "Test Nomenclature," specifies the equipment class, the equipment mounting method, and a test curve or range of test curves. The second section, captioned "Mechanics of Test," specifies the test procedures to be employed and the test times of table 514–II.

3. **EQUIPMENT CLASS.** For purposes of this test method, equipment is categorized according to the vehicle in which it will be installed or according to other conditions as follows:

EQUIPMENT CLASS

1. Aircraft
2. Helicopters
3. Air Launched Missiles
4. Ground Launched Missiles
5. Ground Vehicles
6. Shipment by Common Carrier, Land, Sea, or Air
7. Ground Equipment (excluding ground vehicles)

4. **EQUIPMENT MOUNTING METHODS.**

a. Equipment rigidly mounted to supporting structure, without the use of vibration isolators.

b. Equipment normally mounted on vibration isolators.

c. Equipment normally installed on resiliently mounted racks or panels but requiring a test when the rack or panel is not available.

4.1 Number of Tests to Be Performed. All tests shown in the applicable mounting method block in table 514–I shall be performed. For example, referring to table 514–I, Equipment Class 3, Mounting "B," four tests are specified as indicated by figures 514–1, –1, –3, and –4. All four tests shall be performed to evaluate equipment installed in an air launched missile for both the captive and flight phase.

5. **SELECTION OF TEST CURVES.** Test curves by equipment class are given in figures 514–1 through 514–6. In some instances several test curves are shown for one equipment class. The selection of test curves shall be made after a detailed analysis of the expected vibration environment within the particular vehicle involved. A primary consideration is the equipment location with respect to predominant vibration sources such as high intensity noise of jet and rocket exhausts, aerodynamic excitation including atmospheric wind and turbulence, and unbalance of rotating parts. Additional factors to be considered shall include attenuation or amplification and filtering by structural members. General guidance for the selection of vibration test curves for each equipment class by location is contained in the following paragraphs.

5.1 Aircraft Equipment Test Curves, see figure 514–1.

5.2 Helicopters Equipment Test Curves, see figure 514–2.

5.3 Air Launched Missile Equipment Test Curves. Items of equipment to be installed in air launched missiles shall be subjected to both a captive phase and a flight phase vibration test. The vibration test curve for the captive phase shall be selected from figure 514–1. The vibration test curve for the flight phase shall be selected from figure 514–3 (Sinusoidal Cycling) and figure 514–4 (Random Vibration) since both tests are required as specified in table 514–I. Suggested test curves are given in table 514–III.

5.4 Ground Launched Missile Equipment Test Curves. Items of equipment to be installed in ground launched missiles shall be subjected to sinusoidal cycling test and a random vibration test as specified in table 514–I. Sinusoidal test curves are shown in figure 514–3. Random vibration test curves are shown in figure 514–4. Guidance for the selection of vibration test curves is contained in table 514–III.

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TABLE 514-I

Vibration Test Selection Chart

TEST NOMENCLATURE, Para. 6				MECHANICS OF TEST, Para. 7					
Equip. Class Para. 3	Mounting Para. 4	Test Curve, Para. 5		Notes		Performance, Part I		Resonance Dwell Part II	Time Table 514-II
		Fig. 514-	Curve			Cycling Sinusoidal	Random		
1 Acft.	A	1	B, C, D, or E	-	-	X	-	X	I
	B	1	B, C, D, or E	Step 1	Note 1	X	-	X	I
		1	A	Step 2		X	-	X	II
	C	1	A	-	-	X	-	X	I
2 Helicopters	A	2	B	-	-	X	-	X	I
	B	2	B	Step 1	Note 1	X	-	X	I
		2	A	Step 2		X	-	X	II
	C	2	A	-	-	X	-	X	I
3 Air Launched Missiles	A	1	B or C	Captive Phase		X	-	X	V
		3	B, C, D, or E	Flight Phase		X	-	-	II
		4	B thru F			-	X	-	II
	B	1	B or C	Captive Phase Step 1	Note 1	X	-	X	V
		1	A	Step 2		X	-	X	II
		3	B, C, D, or E	Flight Phase		X	-	-	II
		4	B thru F			-	X	-	II
	C	1	A	Captive Phase		X	-	X	V
		3	A	Flight Phase		X	-	-	II
		4	A			-	X	-	II
4 Ground Launched Missiles	A	3	B thru G	-	-	X	-	-	II
		4	A thru K	-	-	-	X	-	II
	B	3	B thru G	-	-	X	-	-	II
		4	A thru K	Step 1	Note 1	-	X	-	II
		3	A	Step 2		X	-	-	II
	C	3	A	-	-	X	-	-	II
		4	A	-	-	-	X	-	II
5 Ground Vehicles	-	5	A or B	Note 2		X	-	X	III
6 Shipment by common carrier and 7 Ground Equip.	-	6	A	Note 3		X	-	X	IV

Note 1. Equipment normally provided with vibration isolators shall first be tested with the isolators in place in accordance with step 1. The isolators shall then be removed, the equipment rigidly mounted and subjected to the lower G level in accordance with step 2 in order to demonstrate minimum structural resistance to vibration.

Note 2. For ground vehicle equipment weighing more than 143 pounds, the upper frequency limit of figure 514-5 shall be reduced according to the frequency vs. weight requirement of figure 514-7. The lower frequency limit of the test curve may be raised to a value of 15 cps for the performance test regardless of weight.

Note 3. When a transit case or crate is provided for the item, the case or crate shall be included in the test setup. For items of equipment weighing more than 100 pounds, the upper frequency limit of figure 514-6 shall be reduced according to the weight vs. frequency requirement of figure 514-8. The lower frequency limit of the test curve may be raised to a value of 15 cps for the performance test.

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TABLE 514-II

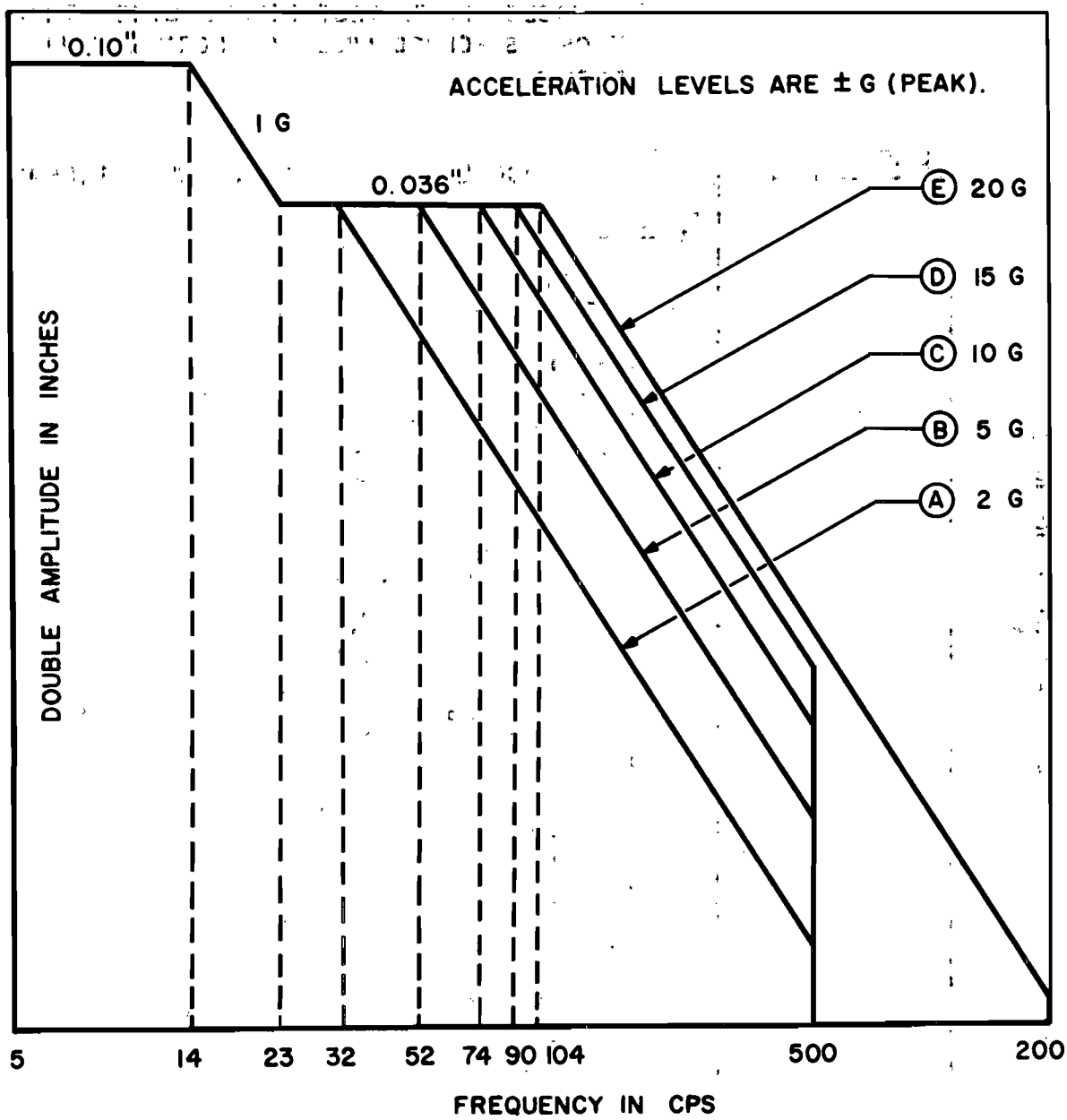
Time Table

(Times shown refer to one axis of vibration)

Time Schedule	RESONANCE DWELL		PERFORMANCE	
	Number of Resonances	Total Time at Resonance	Total Cycling Time	Random Time (When Required by Table 514-I)
I	0	—	3 Hr.	—
	1	½ Hr.	2½ Hr.	—
	2	1 Hr.	2 Hr.	—
	3	1½ Hr.	1½ Hr.	—
	4	2 Hr.	1 Hr.	—
	Dwell 30 minutes at each resonance			
II	0	—	↑	↑
	1	10 min.		
	2	20 min.	30 min.	30 min.
	3	30 min.	↓	↓
	4	40 min.		
	Dwell 10 minutes at each resonance			
III	0	—	4 Hr.	—
	1	¾ Hr.	3¼ Hr.	—
	2	1½ Hr.	2½ Hr.	—
	3	2¼ Hr.	1¾ Hr.	—
	4	3 Hr.	1 Hr.	—
	Dwell 45 minutes at each resonance			
IV	0	—	↑	—
	1	½ Hr.		—
	2	1 Hr.	Note 4	—
	3	1½ Hr.	↓	—
	4	2 Hr.		—
	Dwell 30 minutes at each resonance			
V	0	—	2 Hr.	—
	1	½ Hr.	1½ Hr.	—
	2	1 Hr.	1 Hr.	—
	3	1½ Hr.	½ Hr.	—
	4	2 Hr.	0	—
	Dwell 30 minutes at each resonance			

Note 4. Perform three complete cycles from minimum frequency of figure 514-8 and return to minimum frequency.

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Curve	Aircraft Equipment Location
A	Equipment installed on vibration isolated panels and racks when the panel or rack is not available for test and when specified in table 514–I.
B	Equipment in forward half of fuselage or equipment in wing areas of aircraft with engines at rear of fuselage.
C	Equipment in rear half of fuselage or equipment in wing areas of aircraft with wing mounted engines.
D	Equipment located in the engine compartment or pylon.
E	Equipment mounted directly on aircraft engine.
	Air Launched Missile (captive phase)
B	Equipment in missile attached to wing of aircraft with engine in rear of fuselage.
C	Equipment in missile carried in aircraft fuselage or attached to wing in aircraft with wing mounted engines.

Figure 514–1. Vibration test curves, aircraft equipment and air launched missile (captive phase) equipment.

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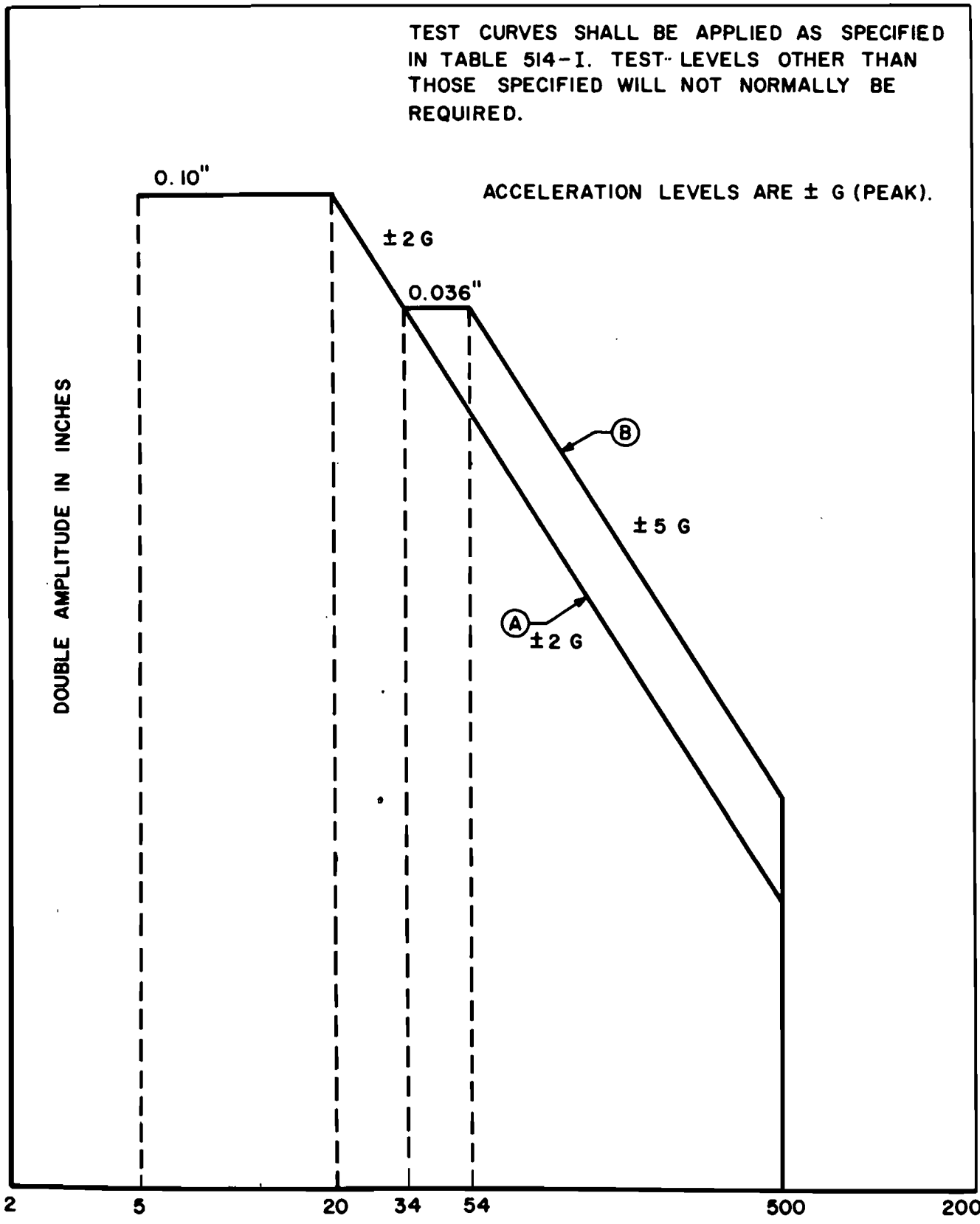


Figure 514-2. Vibration test curves, helicopter equipment.

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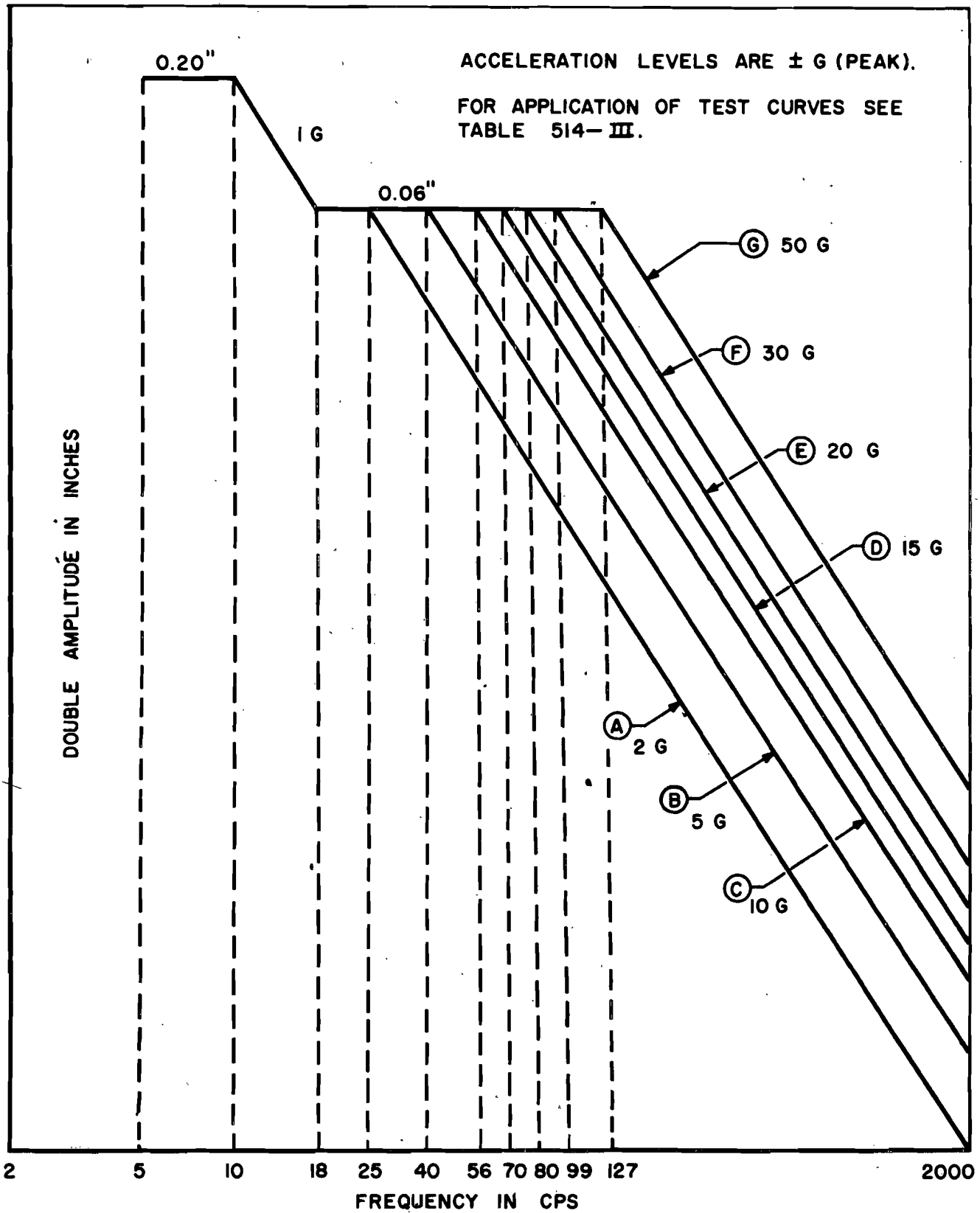
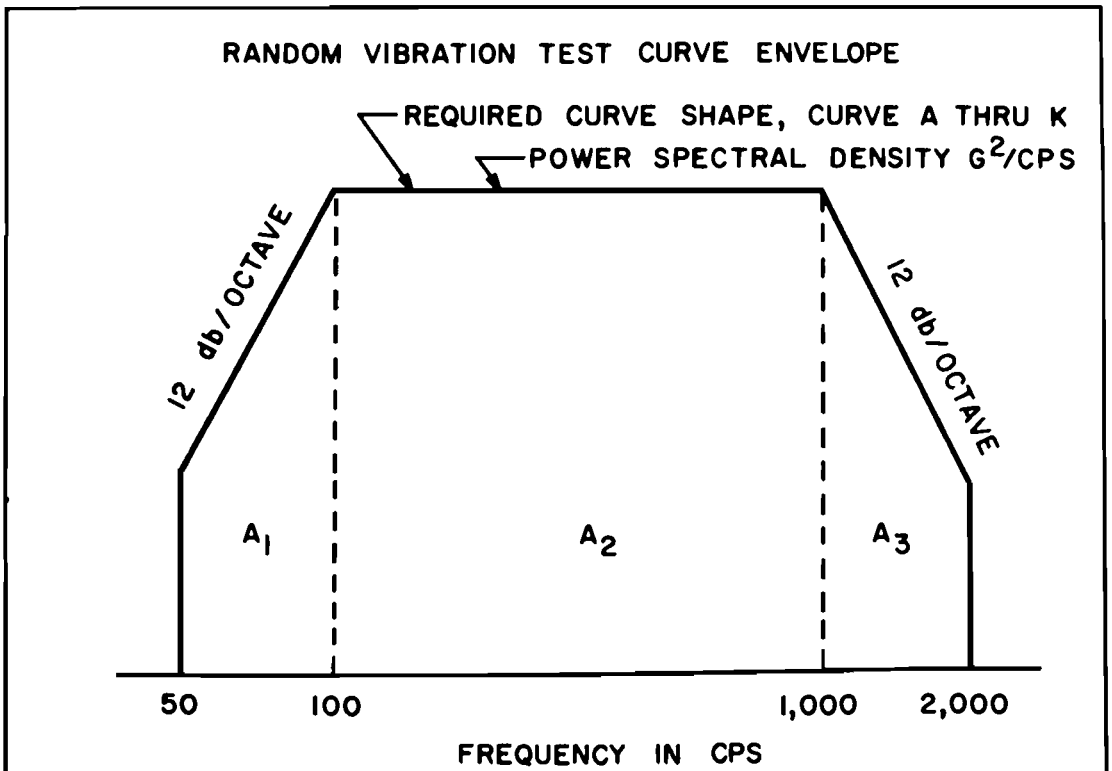


Figure 514-3. Vibration test curves, (sinusoidal), air launched missile (flight phase) and ground launched missile equipment.

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CURVE	POWER SPECTRAL DENSITY	RMS G MINIMUM
A	0.02	5.3
B	0.04	7.5
C	0.06	9.3
D	0.1	11.9
E	0.2	16.9
F	0.3	20.7
G	0.4	23.9
H	0.6	29.3
J	1.0	37.8
K	1.5	46.3

Figure 514-4. Random vibration test curves, air launched missiles (flight phase) and ground launched missiles.

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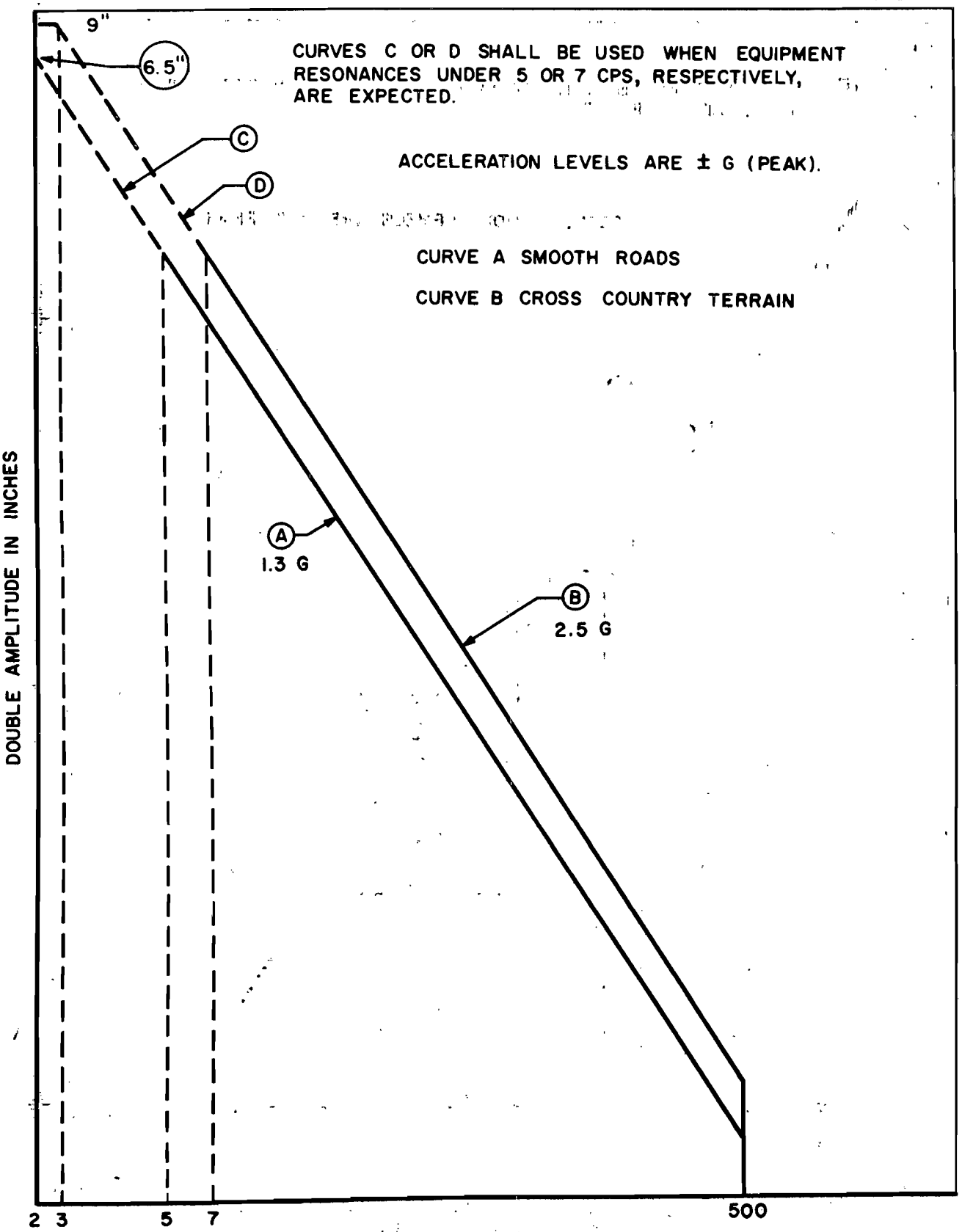


Figure 514–5. Vibration test curves, equipment installed in ground vehicles.

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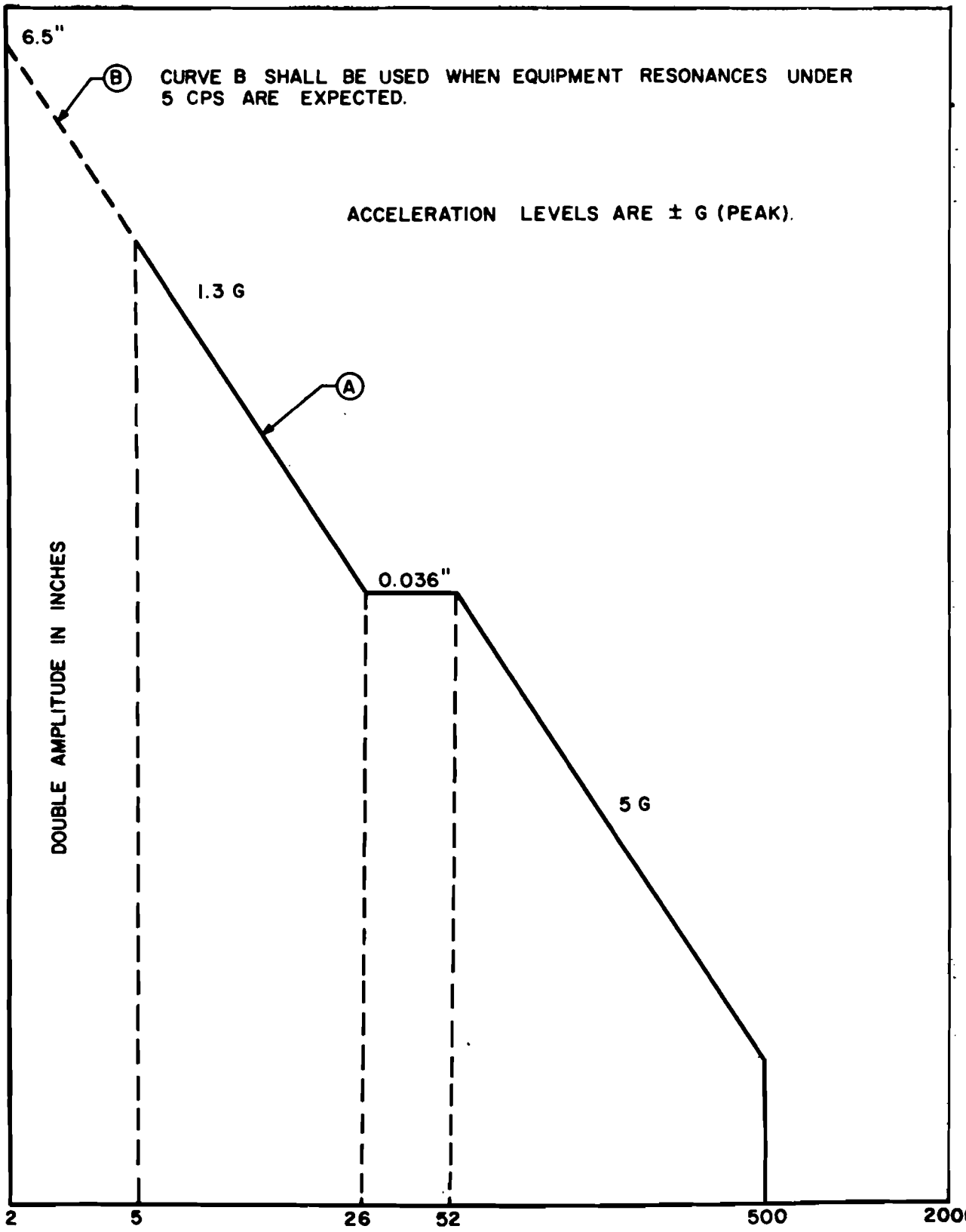


Figure 514–6. Vibration test curves, equipment transported by common carrier.

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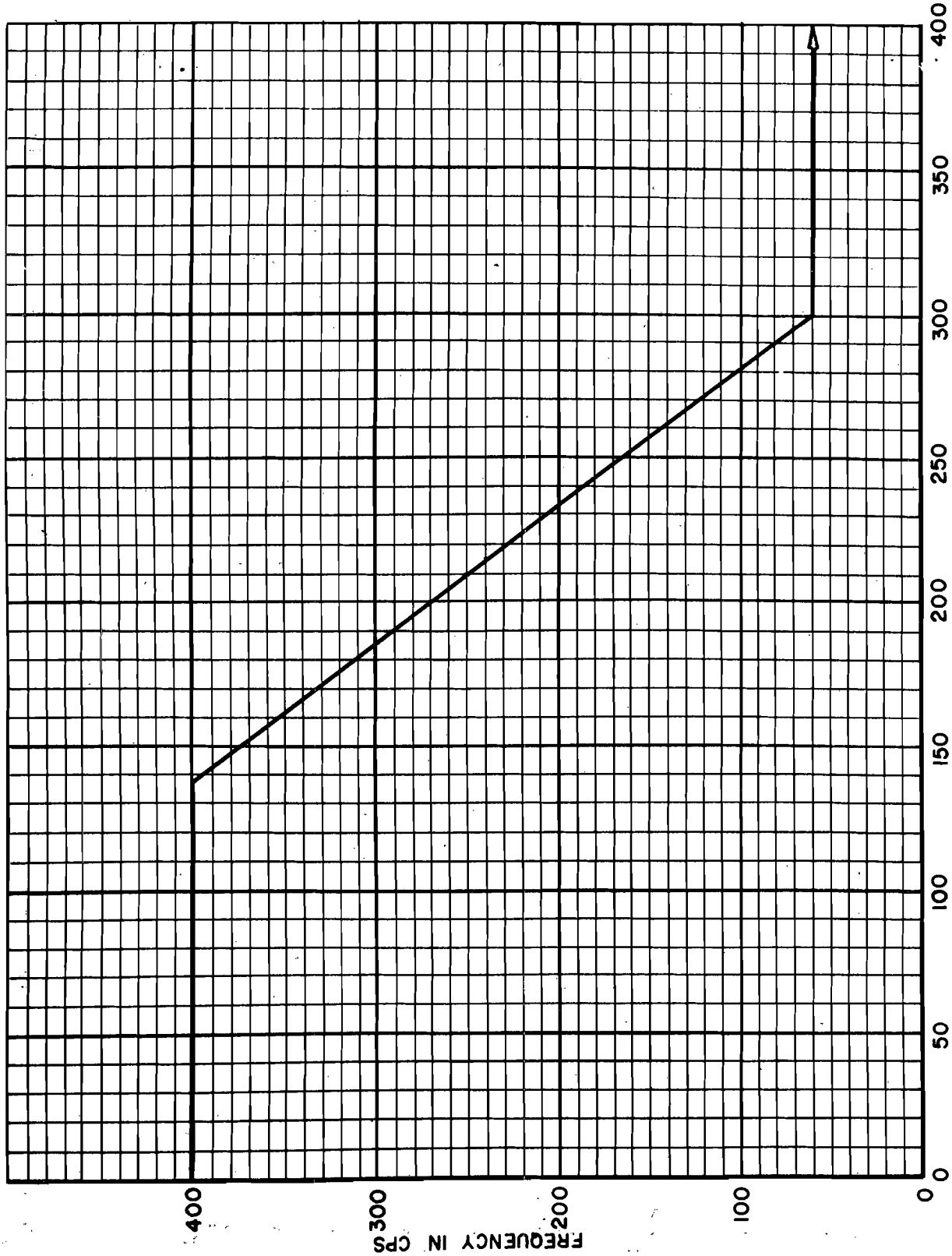


Figure 514–7. Weight vs. frequency. Equipment installed in ground vehicles.

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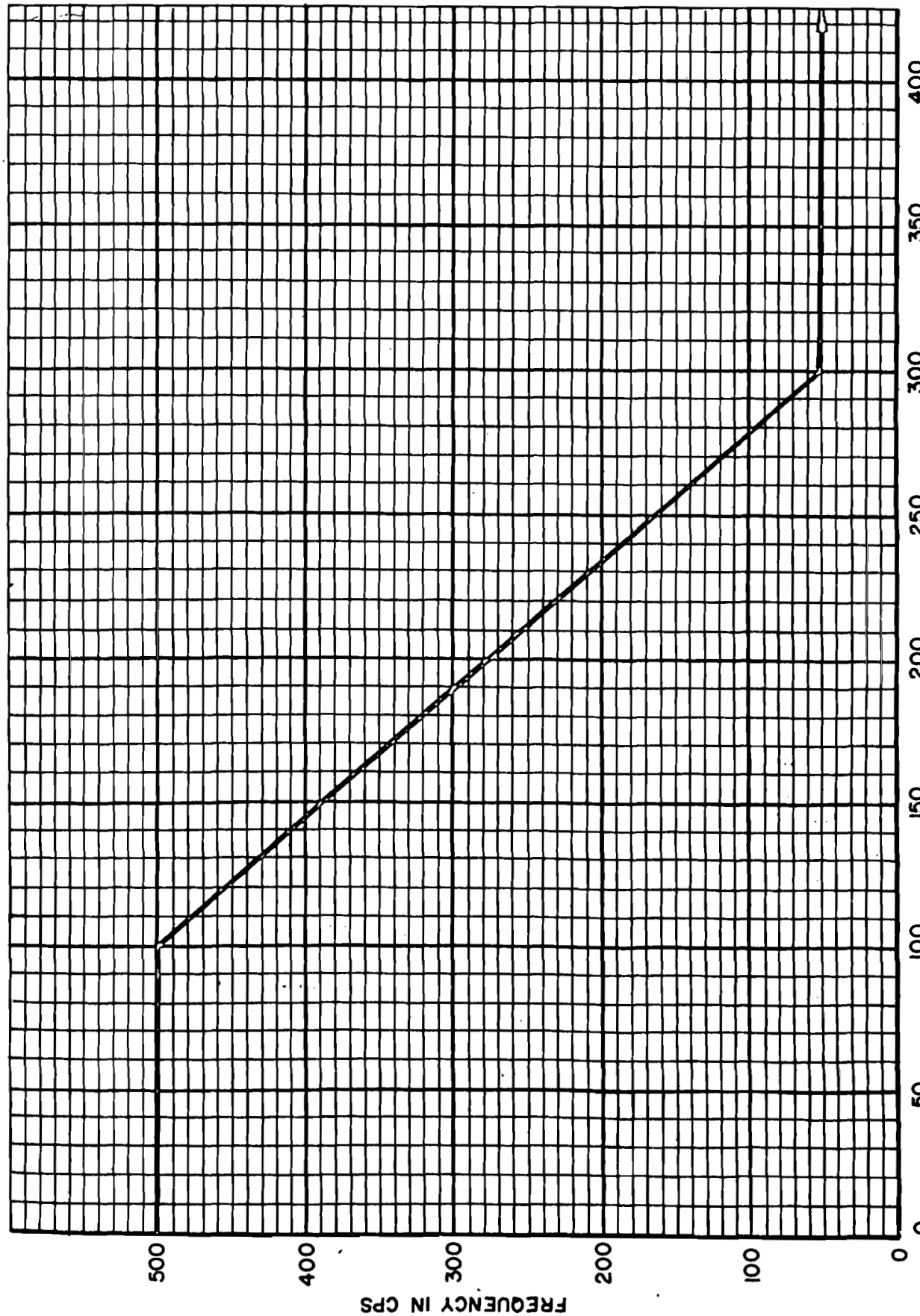


Figure 514–8. Weight vs. frequency. Equipment shipped by common carrier.

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TABLE 514-III

Suggested Vibration Test Curves				
Missile Type	Vibration Test Curves		Approx. Thrust to Weight Ratio or Thrust in Pounds	Equipment Location by Missile Section
	Sinusoidal Fig. 514-3	Random Fig. 514-4		
Air Launched (Flight phase)	E	F	20/1 or greater	Booster
	D	E	5/1 thru 15/1	
	C	D	3/1 or less	
	C	C	15/1 or greater	All locations except Booster
	B	B	Less than 15/1	
Ground Launched	B or C	A, B, or C	—	All except Booster
	C or D	D, E, or F	250,000 lb. or less	By Individual Booster Stage
	D or E	F, G, or H	250,000 lb. to 500,000 lb.	
	F or G	H, J, or K	Over 500,000 lb.	

5.5 Ground Vehicle Equipment Test Curves. Items of equipment to be installed in ground vehicles shall be subjected to a sinusoidal resonance and cycling test as specified in table 514-I. Sinusoidal test curves are shown in figure 514-5. Equipment which is an inherent part of a ground vehicle for use on either smooth roads or cross-country terrain shall be tested as part of the vehicle in accordance with MIL-M-8090, Mobility Requirements, Ground Support Equipment, General Specification for.

5.6 Shipment by Common Carrier, Land, Sea or Air. All items of equipment shipped by common carrier shall be subjected to a sinusoidal resonance and cycling test as specified in table 514-I. Sinusoidal test curves are shown in figure 514-6.

5.7 Ground Equipment (excluding ground vehicle equipment). Unless otherwise specified ground equipment shall be tested for shipment by common carrier only.

6. FORMULATION OF VIBRATION TEST NOMENCLATURE. The sequence of requirements in table 514-I are arranged in a manner which provides the means for formulating a vibration test nomenclature. The vibration test nomenclature shall be formulated from table 514-I, following the selection of requirements, in accordance with the following examples:

EXAMPLE NO. 1

Equipment		Test Curve	
Class	Mounting	Figure 514-	Curve
1	A	1	D

Referring to table 514-I, the above nomenclature specifies a test for equipment installed in an aircraft; equipment which is rigidly mounted; and, tested in accordance with figure 514-1, Curve "D."

EXAMPLE NO. 2

Equipment		Test Curve	
Class	Mounting	Figure 514-	Curve
3	A	1	C
3	A	3	D
3	A	4	F

Referring to table 514-I, since all tests shown for any one mounting method must be performed, it is necessary to specify a three part nomenclature number to completely identify the requirement. For equipment class 3, mounting method B, it is necessary to specify a four part nomenclature number etc.

7. MECHANICS OF TEST. A test shall be performed in accordance with the procedure as indicated by an "X" in the applicable block under the caption "Mechanics of Test" in table 514-I. The duration of the test shall be as specified in time schedule table 514-II in accordance with the time schedule designated by a Roman numeral.

8. Procedure. The vibration environment specified shall be applied to each of the three mutually perpendicular axes of the test item. The entire sequence of tests shall be accomplished for any one axis before changing to the next axis. The test item shall be installed in accordance with section 3.2.2 and attached by its normal mounting means directly to the vibration exciter table, or by means of a rigid fixture capable of transmitting the vibration conditions specified herein. Wherever possible,

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the test load shall be distributed uniformly on the vibration exciter table in order to minimize effects of unbalanced loads.

Procedure I

Performance, Part I.

The performance test may be sinusoidal cycling, random, or a combination of both. For guidance in performing a combined test see paragraph 9.1 of this test method. The test to be applied is dependent on the vehicle in which the equipment is installed and shall be as specified in table 514-I. The test item shall be operating throughout the sinusoidal cycling and or random test. The test item performance during and following the test shall meet the requirements of the detail specification. When the test item is packaged for transportation, operational monitoring of the test item during the test is not applicable.

Sinusoidal Cycling.

The frequency of applied vibration shall be cycled at a logarithmic rate between the frequency limits and at the vibratory acceleration levels of the specified test curve. Logarithmic cycling rates shall be in accordance with figure 514-9 and the specified time schedule of table 514-II. A linear cycling rate may be substituted for logarithmic cycling when performed in accordance with paragraph 9.2 of this test method. When it is specified that a resonance dwell test follow the cycling test, significant resonant modes of the test item shall be determined during the cycling test. The initial frequency sweep/cycling rate shall be decreased when necessary to facilitate the establishment of resonant frequencies. The frequency sweep shall be repeated for portions of the test curve when necessary to precisely locate narrow resonant modes. During, and at the conclusion of the test, the operation of the test item shall be compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1 and shall meet the requirements of the detail specification. The test item shall then be inspected in accordance with section 3.2.4.

Random Vibration.

Unequalized resonant modes of the "moving mass" (test item, fixture, and vibration exciter moving element) shall be compensated for within the frequency range of the specified test curve so that the equalized frequency spectrum shall be as flat as is practically obtainable. Random vibration having a Gaussian distribution and a peak to r.m.s G ratio of 3 to 1 shall be applied according to the specified test curve and time schedule. The equalized spectrum shall be monitored and readjusted as necessary. Control and analysis of random vibration and tolerances are specified in paragraph 9.3 of this test method. During, and at the conclusion of the test, the operation of the test item shall be compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1 and shall meet the requirements of the detail specification. The test item shall then be inspected in accordance with section 3.2.4.

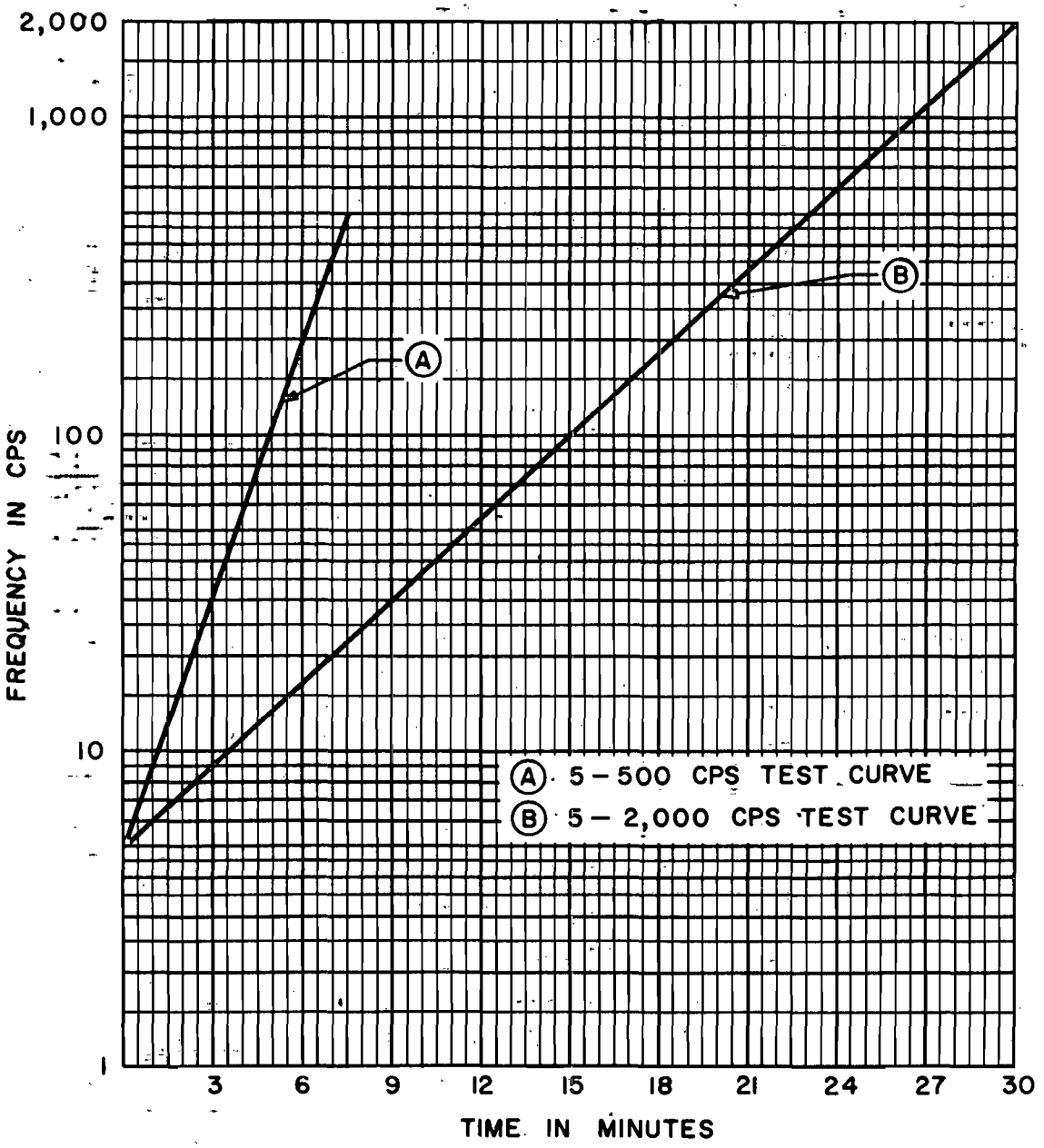
Resonance Dwell, Part II.

The test item shall be operating during the test so that functional effects caused by internal resonances may be observed; however, compliance with tolerances specified in the detail specification is not mandatory. The test item shall be vibrated along each axis at the most severe resonant frequencies according to the specified time schedule and according to the applicable double amplitudes or accelerations of the specified test curve. If more than four significant resonances have been found for any one axis, the four most severe resonances shall be chosen for the test. If a change in the resonant frequency occurs during the test, the frequency shall be adjusted to maintain the resonance condition. For all test items weighing more than 50 pounds (except ground equipment and equipment shipped by common carrier) the vibratory accelerations may be reduced by $\pm$ 1 G for each 10 pound increment of weight over 50 pounds; however, the vibratory acceleration shall in no case be less than 50 percent of the specified test curve level. At the conclusion of the test, the test item shall be operated and the results compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1. The test item shall then be inspected in accordance with section 3.2.4.

9. TEST DETAILS AND TECHNIQUES.

9.1 Combined Sinusoidal Cycling and Random Vibration Test. The sinusoidal cycling and random vibration test shall be combined when the test apparatus permits. The test time shall be 30 minutes along each axis. The sinusoidal vibration test curve acceleration level (specified in peak G) shall be converted to r. m.s G. The acceleration level to be used for the combined test shall then be determined by squaring both test curve acceleration levels, adding them, and then taking the square root of the sum. The combined test level shall then be achieved by obtaining the lower of the two separate levels first, then advancing the gain control for the other separate level until the overall combined test level is achieved. All other test parameters shall be the same as the separate test instructions.

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NOTE: FOR CYCLING TESTS OF LESS THAN 500 CPS MAXIMUM FREQUENCY, THE FREQUENCY RANGE SHALL BE CYCLED LOGARITHMICALLY FROM MINIMUM TO MAXIMUM IN 7.5 MINUTES FOR THE TOTAL TIME PERIOD SPECIFIED.

Figure 514–9. Logarithmic cycling rates.

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9.2 Substitution of Linear Cycling for Logarithmic Cycling. When a linear cycling rate is used, the total frequency range shall be divided into logarithmic frequency bands of equal cycling time intervals. The linear cycling rate for each band is then determined by dividing each banwidth in cps by the item in minutes for each band. The logarithmic frequency bands may be readily determined from figure 514-9. The frequency bands and linear cycling rates shown in table 514-IV shall be used for the 5 to 500 cps and 5 to 2,000 cps frequency ranges. For test frequency ranges of 100 cps or less, no correction of the linear cycling rate is required.

TABLE 514-IV

Linear Cycling Rates

Total Frequency Range	Frequency Bands cps	Cycling Time in Minutes	Linear Cycling Rate cps/min
5 to 500 cps	5.0 to 22.5	2.5	7
	22.5 to 100	2.5	31
	100 to 500	2.5	160
5 to 2000 cps	5.0 to 22.5	7.5	2.33
	22.5 to 100	7.5	10.33
	100 to 450	7.5	46.67
	450 to 2000	7.5	206.67

9.3 Control and Analysis of Random Vibration. Random equalization shall be within ± 3 db between the frequencies of 50 and 1,000 cps; ±6 db * between 1,000 and 2,000 cps. Attenuation outside the flat portion of the frequency spectrum shall be 12 db/octave or less for the frequency range shown in figure 514-4. A wave analyzer shall be used to assure that the equalization tolerances have been attained and that the spectrum shape is satisfactory. The following wave analyzer characteristics shall be reported for each test:

a. Filter bandwidths
b. Integrator time constant
c. Amplitude accuracy

The overall r. m.s G applied shall be maintained within a tolerance of $\begin{cases} + & 15\% \\ - & 5\%. \end{cases}$

* $db = 20 \ Log \frac{E_1}{E_2}$

9.4 Vibration Input Control. The vibratory acceleration levels or double amplitudes of the specified test curve shall be maintained at the test item mounting points. For large test items, where there is a variation of the input vibration level between mounting points, the minimum input vibration shall be that of the specified test curve. Transverse motion (crosstalk) measured at the test item attachment points shall be limited to 100% of the applied vibration.

9.5 Combined Temperature-Vibration Test. Tests shall be conducted under room ambient conditions unless the detail specification requires a high or low temperature vibration test, in which case the temperature extremes and time duration shall be as specified in the detail specification.

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METHOD 515

ACOUSTICAL NOISE

1. **PURPOSE.** The acoustical noise test is conducted to determine the effects on aerospace equipment of acoustic sound fields that are characteristic of aircraft, missile and other high performance vehicles. In general, equipments located in areas where noise levels are 130 db overall or less will not require testing to noise environments. The acoustical noise test is not intended to be a substitute for the conventional sinusoidal or random vibration test when specified in the detail equipment specification. The test described herein should be considered only as a supplement to the specified shock and vibration tests.

2. **CRITERIA FOR APPLICATION OF ACOUSTIC TEST.** Some equipments are insensitive to acoustic stimulation even at very high levels. Other equipments may respond in a manner that will modify or disrupt the equipment function. In extreme cases mechanical failure may result. Equipments that are sensitive to vibration are usually sensitive to sound field exposure. For this reason a suitable vibration test is often a good indicator of acoustic sensitivity. However, it is possible that high frequency resonances of some responding equipment elements may be overlooked during the vibration test due to high frequency limitations of the shaker and vibration attenuation of the test jig and the equipment under test. The following criteria are presented as a guide for the initial determination of equipment sensitivity to acoustic stimuli. Such criteria cannot be considered as the single determining factor. The final decision, whether or not to test, must be supplemented by such additional factors as a description of the characteristics and duration of the sound field, the location of the equipment within the vehicle structure, and a consideration of special mounting means or protective enclosures employed for the equipment.

2.1 **Assessment of Equipment.** Of importance is the fact that some equipments may possess both sensitive and insensitive properties, and, that in some equipments it may be difficult to assess the properties themselves. With this understanding the general criteria for evaluating the incipient acoustic sensitivities of equipments are contained in the following paragraphs.

2.1.1 **Insensitive Properties.** Equipments with insensitive properties are those having small surface areas (several square feet or less), high mass to volume ratios, and high internal damping. Examples are as follows:

a. High density modules, particularly the solid or encapsulated type.

b. Modules or packages with solid state elements mounted on small constrained or damped printed circuit boards or matrices.

c. Mass-like valves, hydraulic servo controls, auxiliary power units, pumps, etc.

d. Equipments surrounded by heavy metallic castings, particularly those that are potted or are encased within the casting by attenuating media.

2.1.2 **Sensitive Properties.** Equipments with sensitive properties are those normally classified as being microphonic and those having large compliant areas of exposure, low mass to area ratios and low internal damping. Examples are as follows:

a. Equipment containing microphonic elements with high frequency resonances such as electron tubes, wave guides, klystrons, magnetrons, piezoelectric components, and relays attached to thin plate surfaces.

b. Equipments containing or consisting of exposed diaphragmatic elements such as pressure sensitive transducers, valves, switches, relays, and flat spiral antenna units.

3. **SELECTION OF TEST GRADE.** The noise levels and duration of exposure are divided into four intensity categories as listed in table 515-I.

The grades are in order of increasing severity (overall sound pressure level) from A through D. The grade should be selected as appropriate for the expected acoustic level. Normally grade A will cover the majority of applications in jet aircraft. In some cases where the location of the equipment is very close to the noise source (within several feet) or within the 45 degree cone of the jet, and, if the intervening partitions are of thin shell like walls, testing to the intensity of grade B may be required. Grades C and D represent the intense sound fields generated by

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TABLE 515–I

Sound Test Schedule		
Grade	Test Overall Sound Pressure Level—db *	Exposure Time
A	140	30 minutes
B	150	30 minutes
C	160	30 minutes
D	165	30 minutes

* Ref. 2 × 10 $^{-4}$ dynes/cm^2

large rocket thrust vehicles. Grade C is recommended for equipment locations forward of the booster compartment extending to the forward or nose cone regions. Grade D is recommended for locations in the booster compartment near the thrust source and may include instrument pods externally mounted on the booster sides.

4. APPARATUS. The reverberation test enclosure shall be a chamber suitably formed and proportioned to produce, as close as possible, a diffuse sound field, the sound energy density of which is very nearly uniform throughout the enclosure. A pentagonal chamber configuration is recommended. Acute angles of adjacent chamber walls shall be avoided wherever possible.

5. MOUNTING OF TEST ITEM. The test item shall be suspended in the test chamber by means of soft suspension cords such as soft springs or elastic cord, and in accordance with section 3.2.2. The natural frequency of all modes of suspension shall be less than 25 cps. The test item shall be exposed on every surface to the sound field by centrally locating it in the test chamber. The test item volume should be no more than 10 percent of the test chamber volume. When the test chamber is a rectanguloid no major surface of the test item shall be installed parallel to a chamber wall.

6. PROCEDURE

Procedure I

Step 1—Measurement of sound pressure field. The sound pressure field shall be measured with the test item mounted in the test chamber. Measurements shall be made by using a microphone (more than one if desired) to measure the test item sound field in proximity to each major dissimilar surface. The overall sound pressure level desired or selected from table 515–I, reduced by 5 db, shall then be introduced into the test chamber and adjusted to conform with the octave band spectrum specified in figure 515–1. The time required to conduct the survey should not be comparable to the final test time. The sound pressure level and the survey time are reduced to avoid possible premature damage to the test item. The microphone shall be moved over the test item surface and at least 18 inches distant from the test item surface. The measurements made within this volume shall then be averaged.

Step 2—Performance of test. When step 1 is accomplished the overall noise level shall be raised to the value desired or selected from table 515–I and the test shall commence. The average sound pressure distribution around the test item should be uniform within 0 to + 4 db of the desired value. Test times shall be as specified in table 515–I. The operation of the test item shall be monitored when and as specified in the detail specification. When measurements are made during or following the test they shall be compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1. At the conclusion of the test the test item shall be inspected in accordance with section 3.2.4. In the event the test item malfunctions during the test but performs satisfactorily afterwards, a single frequency sound or vibration test should be performed to determine whether the malfunction can be duplicated. In the application of a single frequency sound, the sound pressure field shall be measured as specified in Procedure 1, step 1. A single frequency sound or vibration threshold at which a similar malfunction is observed should be recorded and compared with the results obtained from the continuous spectrum tests.

7. DEFINITIONS AND TERMS. A comprehensive list of standard terminology is contained in American Standards Association documents S 1.1–1960 titled "Acoustical Terminology (Including Mechanical Shock and Vibration)."

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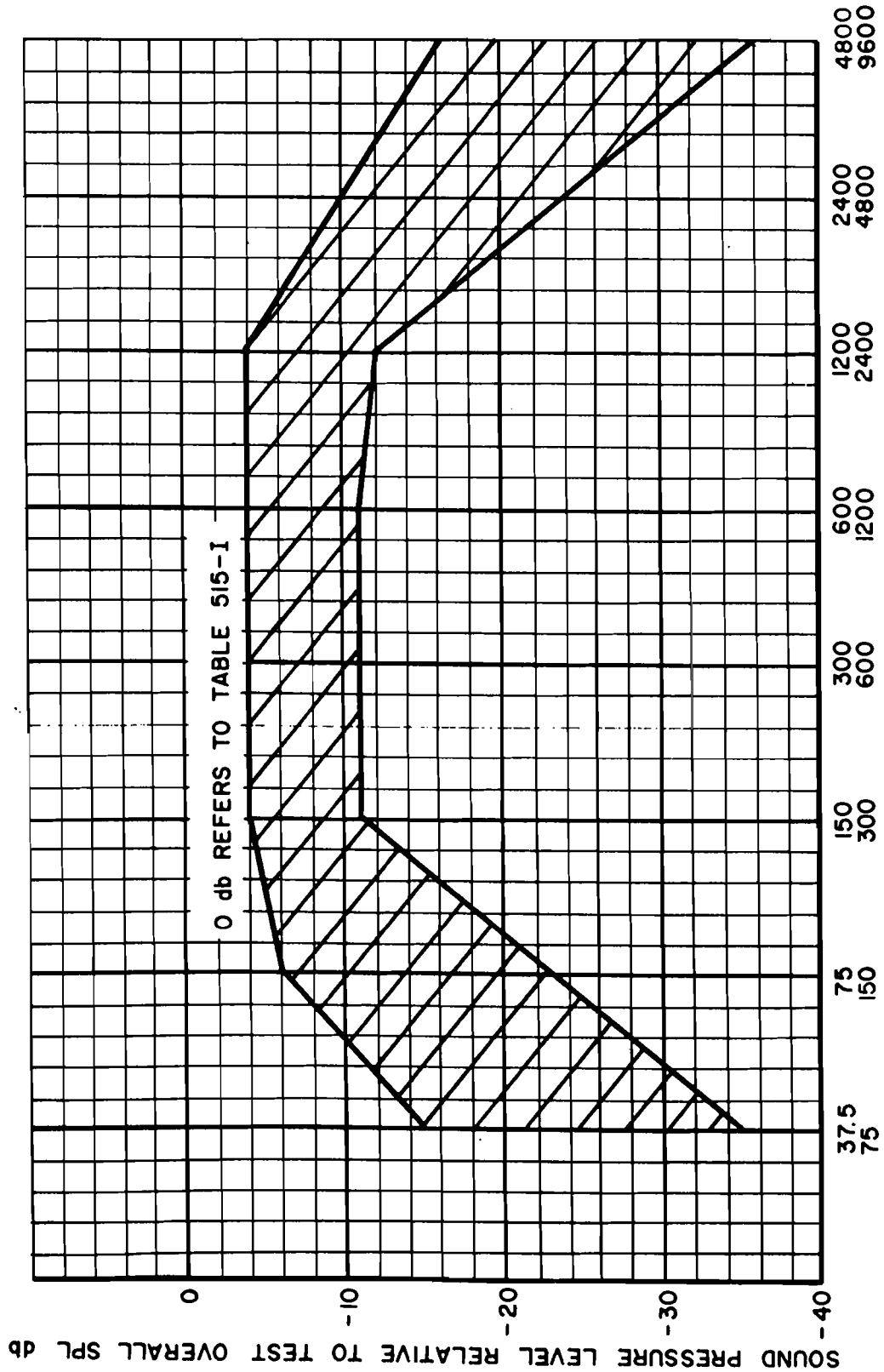


Figure 515-1. Continuous spectrum for noise test.

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METHOD 516

SHOCK

1. **PURPOSE.** The shock test is conducted to determine that structural integrity and performance of aerospace and ground equipment are satisfactory with respect to the mechanical shock environment expected in handling, transportation (excluding equipment packaged for logistic supply and shipment) and service use.

2. **APPARATUS.**

2.1 **Shock Machine.** The shock machine utilized shall be capable of producing the specified input shock pulse shown in figure 516–1 or figure 516–2. The shock machine may be free fall, resilient rebound, nonresilient, hydraulic, compressed gas, or other.

2.2 **Instrumentation.** The instrumentation used to measure the input shock pulse, in order to meet the tolerance requirements of the test procedure, shall have the characteristics specified in the following paragraphs.

2.2.1 **Frequency Response.** The frequency response of the complete measuring system, from the transducer through the readout instrument, shall be as specified by figure 516–3. Particular care shall be exercised in the selection of each individual instrument of the shock measuring instrumentation system in order to assure compatibility with the prescribed frequency response tolerance.

2.2.2 **Transducer, Piezoelectric.** When a piezoelectric accelerometer is employed as the shock sensor, the fundamental resonant frequency of the accelerometer shall be greater than 14,000 cps (resonant frequencies of 30 kc or higher are recommended). For suitable low frequency response the accelerometer and load (cathode follower, amplifier, or other load) shall have the following characteristics:

$$RC \geq 0.08$$

Where R = Load resistance (ohms)

C = transducer capacitance plus shunt capacitance of cable and load (farads)

2.2.3 **Transducer, Strain Gage.** Strain gage transducers may be used provided the undamped natural frequency is equal to or greater than 1,500 cps with damping approximately 0.64 to 0.70 of critical. (Resonant frequencies greater than 1,500 cps are recommended).

2.2.4 **Transducer Calibration.** Transducers shall be calibrated against a standard transducer or by optical means, either of which shall have an accuracy of ±5 percent.

3. **SHOCK PULSE.** This test method specifies two types of machine shocks; a half sine shock pulse and a sawtooth shock pulse. The pulse shapes and tolerances are shown in figure 516–1 and figure 516–2 respectively. Distortion of the half sine pulse shall not be greater than ±10 percent of the peak value of the pulse at any point on the pulse.

3.1 **Half Sine Shock.** The half sine pulse shall be utilized for shock testing individual equipment assemblies (mechanical, electrical, hydraulic, electronic, etc.) of medium size and density, including items of equipment which mount on vibration isolators and equipment racks.

3.2 **Sawtooth Shock.** The sawtooth pulse shock test shall be used where high acceleration short time duration shock excitation results from handling, stage ignition, separation, re-entry, and high velocity aerodynamic buffeting experienced by missiles and high performance weapon systems. This test shall be utilized for testing such items as small high density electronic equipments and other aeronautical items of small size mounted without shock and vibration isolators.

4. **PROCEDURE.** The test item shall be rigidly attached to the shock machine table for procedures I, II, IV, and V in accordance with section 3.2.2. Wherever possible the test load shall be distributed uniformly on the test platform in order to minimize effects of unbalanced loads.

Procedure I.

Basic Design Test

Three shocks in each direction shall be applied along the three mutually perpendicular axes of the test item (18 shocks). If the test item is normally mounted on vibration isolators, the isolators shall be functional during the test.

The shock pulse shape shall be in accordance with figure 516–1 and shall have a peak value of 15 G and a duration of 11 milliseconds. The test item shall be operating during and after the test if required

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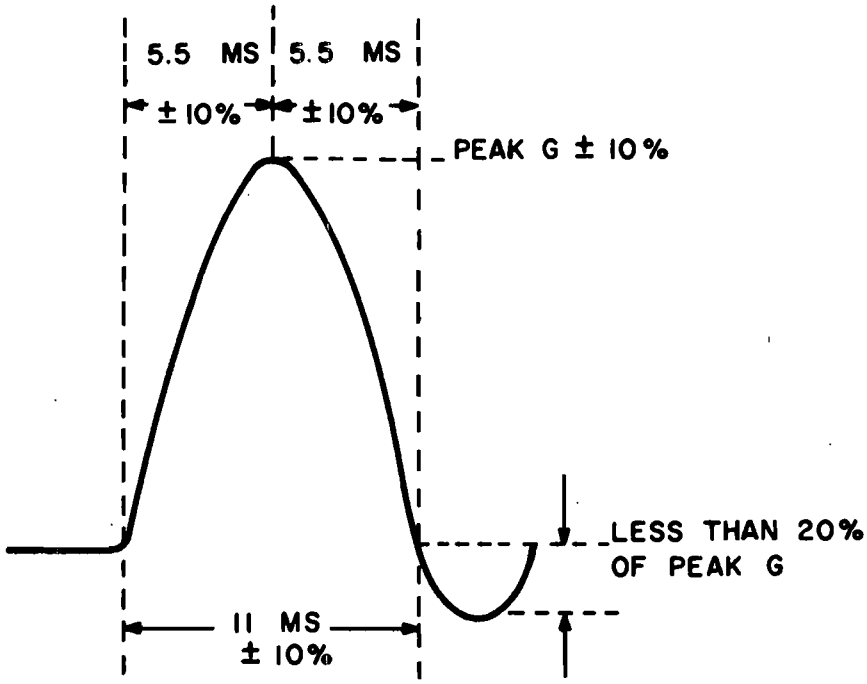


FIGURE 516-1. HALF SINE SHOCK PULSE.

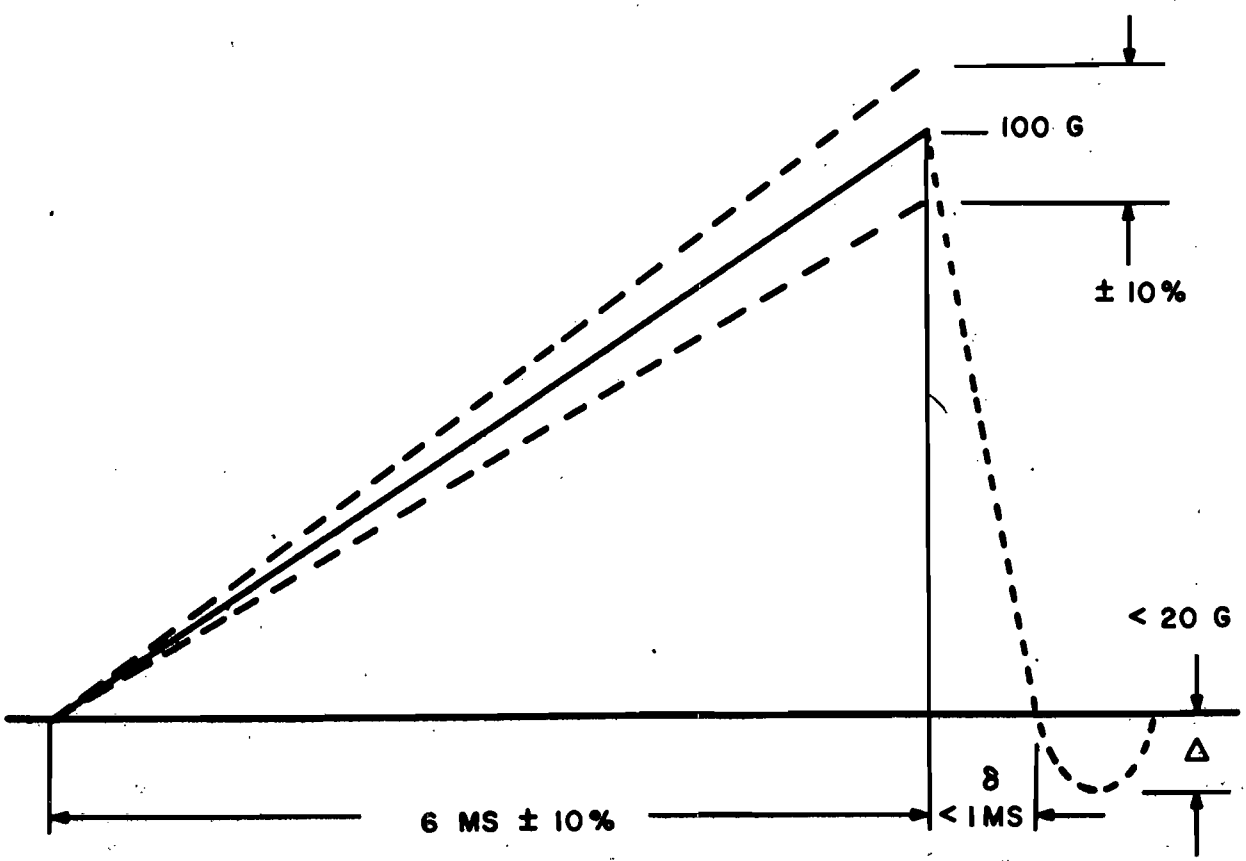


Figure 516-2. Sawtooth Shock Pulse Configuration.

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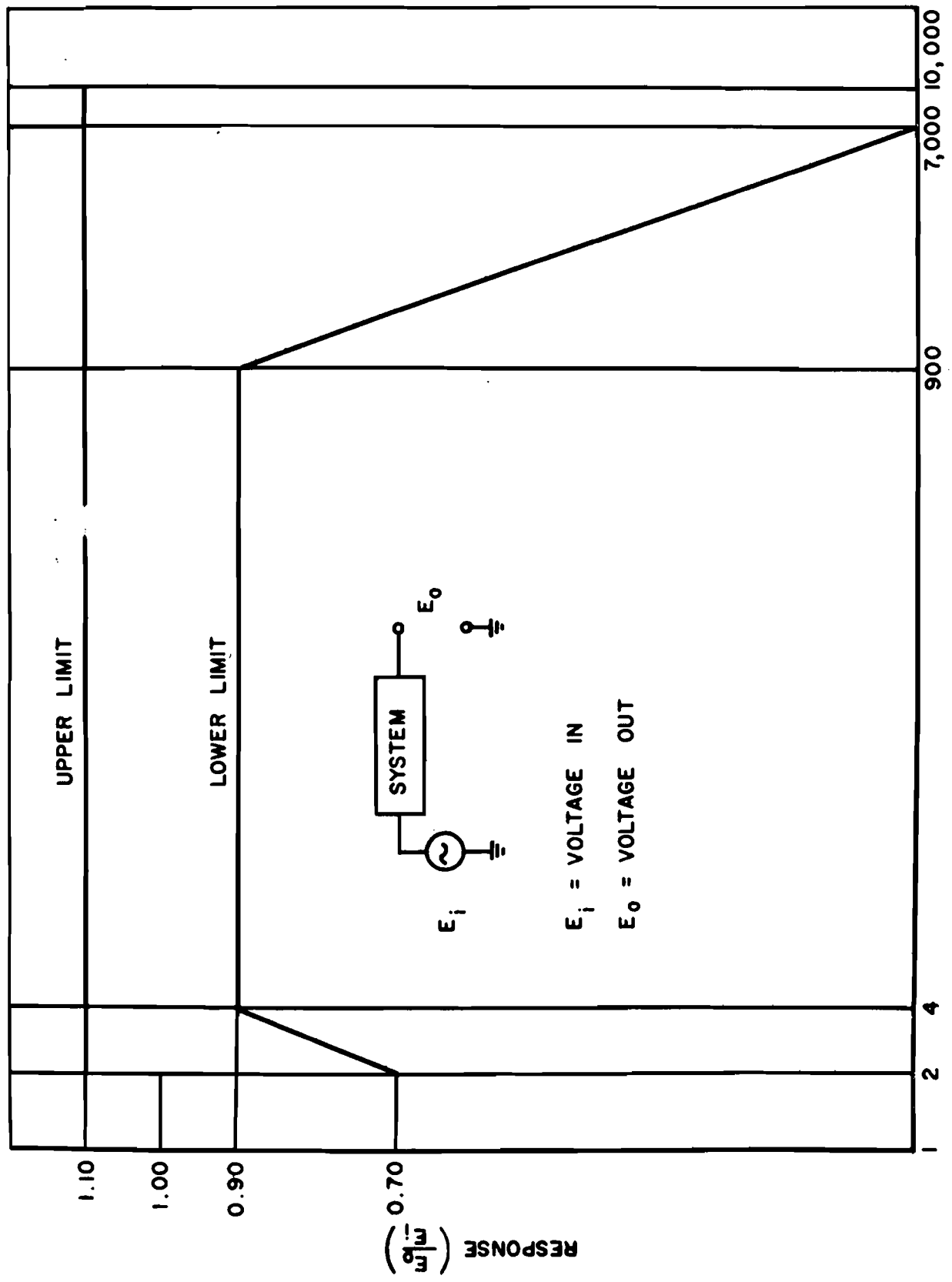


Figure 516-3. System Frequency Response.

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by the detail specification. At the conclusion of the test the test item shall be operated and the results compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1. The test item shall then be inspected as specified in section 3.2.4.

Procedure II.

Transit Test

This procedure is applicable to equipment transported by land, sea, or air, both packaged and unpackaged (excluding equipment packaged for logistic or supply shipment and delivery). The test item shall be installed in the package when provided. To each of the six sides of the package when mounted on the test plate, three shocks shall be applied in turn in each direction along the three mutually perpendicular axes (18 shocks). The shock pulse shape shall be in accordance with figure 516–1 and shall have a peak value of 30 G and a duration of 11 milliseconds. The test item shall not be operating during the test. At the conclusion of the test the test item shall be operated and the results compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1. The test item shall then be inspected as specified in section 3.2.4.

Procedure III.

Alternate Transit Test

This test shall be used in lieu of Procedure II when adequate test machines are not available, and is applied to determine the ability of equipment to resist damage from shock due to handling associated with transportation. This test procedure is applicable to equipment in the package in the nonoperating condition.

In the performance of this test step "a" through step "c" shall be performed where applicable as specified in table 516–I, followed by step "d."

TABLE 516–I
Drop Test

Gross Weight Not Exceeding	Dimensions on Any Edge or Diameter Not Exceeding	Free Fall Drop Test (Height of Drop)	Edgewise Drop Test Height of Drop)	Cornerwise Drop Test (Height of Drop)
Pounds	Inches	Inches	Inches	Inches
50	36	30	—	—
100	48	21	—	—
150	60	18	—	—
200	60	16	—	—
600	72	—	36	36
3000	No Limit	—	24	24
No Limit	No Limit	—	12	12

Step a. Free fall Drop Test. The packaged test item of the applicable gross weights and dimensions specified in table 516–I shall be dropped cornerwise onto a hard, level, concrete floor or equal surface on each of its eight corners, falling freely through the vertical distances specified in table 516–I. Prior to each drop, the package shall be suspended with its center of gravity vertically above the striking corner.

Step b. Edgewise Drop Test. The packaged test item of the applicable gross weight specified in table 516–I shall be tested as follows: One end of the base of the package shall be supported on a sill 5 to 6 inches in height. The opposite end shall be raised and allowed to fall freely to a hard level concrete floor or equal surface from the height of drop specified in table 516–I. The test shall be applied once to each end of the package.

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If the size of the package and the location of the center of gravity are such that this drop cannot be made from the prescribed height, the greatest height attainable shall be substituted.

Step c. Cornerwise Drop Test. The packaged test item having the applicable gross weight specified in table 516–I shall be tested as follows: One corner of the base of the package shall be supported on a block approximately 5 inches in height. A block nominally 12 inches in height shall be placed under the other corner of the same end. The opposite end of the package shall be raised and allowed to fall freely to a hard level concrete floor or equal surface from the heights specified in table 516–I. This test shall be applied once to each of two diagonally opposite corners of the base. If the size of the package and the location of the center of gravity are such that this drop cannot be made from the prescribed height, the greatest height attainable shall be substituted. When the proportions of width and height of the package are such to cause instability in the cornerwise drop test, edgewise drops shall be substituted. In such instances two edgewise drops on each end shall be conducted.

Step d. Impact Test. Packaged equipment having a gross weight exceeding 200 pounds or any dimension more than 60 inches, closed as for transport, shall be subjected to one of the following impact tests. The test shall be applied once to each side and end that has dimensions of less than 9.5 feet.

(1) Pendulum Impact Test. The packaged test item shall be suspended from a height at least 16 feet above the floor by 4 or more ropes, chains or cables; shall be pulled back so that the center of gravity has been raised 9 inches, and then shall be released and permitted to swing freely into a barrier. The barrier shall be a flat rigid wood, concrete or masonry wall or other equally unyielding flat obstacle that is oriented perpendicular to the line of swing.

(2) Incline Impact (Conbur) Test. The packaged test item shall be made to strike a flat rigid surface at a velocity of 7 feet per second. The procedure shall conform to ASTM Standard Method D 880, "The Incline Impact Test for Shipping Containers" suitably modified to accommodate the package.

At the conclusion of the test the test item shall be operated and the results compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1. The test item shall then be inspected as specified in section 3.2.4.

Procedure IV.

Crash Safety Test

This test is conducted to determine the structural integrity of equipment mounting means. If no mounting base or vibration insolators are used, the test item shall be attached by its normal points of attachment. The test item shall be subjected to two shocks in each direction along the three mutually perpendicular axes of the equipment (12) shocks. The shock pulse shape shall be half sine in accordance with figure 516–1, and shall have a peak value of 30 G, and a duration of 11 milliseconds. Bending and distortion shall be permitted. There shall be no failure of the mounting attachment and the test item or dummy load shall remain in place.

Procedure V.

Sawtooth Test

The sawtooth test shall be performed in accordance with figure 516–2. Two shocks shall be applied to the test item in each direction along each of the three mutually perpendicular axes (12 shocks). The test item shall be operating during and after the test if required by the detail specification. At the conclusion of the test the test item shall be operated and the results compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1. The test item shall then be inspected as specified in section 3.2.4.

Procedure VI.

Bench Handling Test

This test is conducted to determine the ability of equipment to withstand the shock encountered during servicing. The chassis and front panel assembly shall be removed from its enclosure, as for servicing, and placed in a suitable position for servicing on a solid bench top. The test shall be performed, as follows, in a manner simulating shocks liable to occur during servicing.

Step a. Using one edge as a pivot, tilt the opposite edge of the assembly until the horizontal axis forms an angle of 45° with the table, or the opposite edge is 4 inches above the table, whichever occurs first, and permit the assembly to

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drop freely to the horizontal. Repeat, using other practicable edges of the same horizontal face as pivots, for a total of four drops.

Step b. Repeat step a, with the assembly resting on other faces until it has been dropped for a total of four times on each face on which the assembly could be placed practicably during servicing. The test item shall not be operating during the test. At the conclusion of the test the test item shall be operated and the results compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1. The test item shall then be inspected as specified in section 3.2.4.

Note: Related Shock Tests. A test for simulating missile impact, hard landings, etc., may be performed by employing a rocket sled test facility with a suitable impact barrier. For shock testing equipment located at or in missile hardsites, facilities such as that mentioned above and conventional shock machines, depending on the shock anticipated, may be used as a rough approximation of equipment suitability.

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METHOD 517
LOW PRESSURE-SOLAR ENERGY

1. PURPOSE. The low pressure solar energy test is conducted to determine whether aerospace vehicles such as satellites, external instrumentation packages, spacecraft, and space stations, with associated equipment, can withstand the deleterious effects of combined space environments. Such environments and conditions include solar radiation, low pressure, temperature gradients, and natural heat sink conditions. Damaging effects include sublimation and deterioration of materials, change in friction coefficients, and change in operating characteristics of equipment. Conditions and effects related to zero gravity, micrometeorite hits, and high energy particle radiation are recognized but, because of inadequate simulation techniques, are not included in this test method.

2. SCOPE. The tests described in this test method are intended for the evaluation of complete aerospace vehicles including installed equipment.

3. PREPARATION FOR TEST. In preparing the environmental and flight program for a test, typical information needed would be as follows:

a. Need for simulating emitted and reflected thermal radiation from the earth or other planets as applicable.

b. Rotational modes and attitude orientation, as applicable.

c. Programming of solar electromagnetic energy in accordance with the mission. (Day and night orbiting periods for satellites, instrumentation packages, etc.)

d. Equipment operation duty cycles.

e. Duration of test. (Number of orbits, time in flight, etc.)

f. Method for monitoring equipment during test.

g. Operating parameters to be monitored.

h. Allowable deviation from specified tolerances.

i. Coupling of radio frequency outputs to dummy loads.

j. Substitution of rechargeable batteries for the vehicle's primary power source.

k. Omission of fuels and oxidizers.

l. Statement of reliability and failure criteria.

m. Other applicable requirements.

4. PROCEDURE.

Procedure I. The test item shall be placed in the test chamber in accordance with section 3.2.2. The temperature control surfaces of the test item shall not directly face any abnormal heat source. An operational performance check shall be accomplished in accordance with section 3.2.1. All equipment shall be operated during the test under the conditions and duty cycles specified in the detail specification. The test chamber pressure shall then be reduced to 1×10^{-5} mm Hg or lower and the chamber walls cooled to —195°C (—320°F). Within one hour of this cooling, radiant energy of 460 ± 16 BTU/ft.^{2}/hr. (Earth orbit intensity) shall be applied to the surface of the test item in the direction corresponding to that of the Sun in space. The simulated solar electromagnetic energy distribution emitted shall be that specified in table 517-I.

TABLE 517-I
Solar Electromagnetic Energy Distribution

TYPE	Wave Length In ANGSTROMS	PERCENT
Far Ultraviolet	1 to 2,000	0.02
Near Ultraviolet	2,000 to 3,800	7.3
Visible	3,800 to 7,800	50.0
Near Infrared	7,800 to 10,000	15.0
Infrared	10,000 to 20,000	22.0
Far Infrared	20,000 to 100,000	5.7

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The normal rotational mode of the test item along with other requirements and conditions shall then be established and maintained throughout the test. All equipment shall be operated (excluding any propulsion system) in accordance with specified duty cycles. Equipment operation shall be monitored during the test and the measurements compared with the data obtained in accordance with section 3.2.1. At the conclusion of the test the test chamber shall be returned to standard ambient conditions and the test item inspected in accordance with section 3.2.4.

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REVISIONS TO TEST METHODS

METHOD NO.	DATE	TITLE
500	14 June 1962	Low Pressure
501	14 June 1962	High Temperature
502	14 June 1962	Low Temperature
503	14 June 1962	Temperature Shock
504	14 June 1962	Temperature—Altitude (Cycling)
505	14 June 1962	Sunshine
506	14 June 1962	Rain
507	14 June 1962	Humidity
508	14 June 1962	Fungus
509	14 June 1962	Salt Fog
510	14 June 1962	Sand and Dust
511	14 June 1962	Explosion
512	14 June 1962	Immersion (Leakage)
513	14 June 1962	Acceleration
514	14 June 1962	Vibration
515	14 June 1962	Acoustical Noise
516	14 June 1962	Shock
517	14 June 1962	Low Pressure—Solar Energy

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